Dual Tetrad Gravity And The Field Origin
Fundamental Constants from the Tetrahedral Coupling Topology

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Abstract

General relativity requires that the gravitational field be non-degenerate at every point: $\det(g) \neq 0$. In the tetrad formalism, this field closure condition demands that four basis vectors span the tangent space completely, defining a tetrahedron at each node of the gravitational field. Ghost-free bimetric gravity couples two such tetrad fields at a single interaction vertex, the Field Origin, through a potential with five free parameters β_0 through β_4. This paper proves that the Hassan-Rosen frame transition matrix is identically the coupled face matrix of the dual tetrahedron topology, and that parity, metric exchange symmetry, and field closure under finite propagation speed determine all five β_n, leaving zero adjustable coupling constants.

The topology is read in two directions. Read for *depth*, the coupling polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 21$ yields the gravitational constant: $G = (17/13)\,\alpha^{21}\,\hbar c/m_e^2$, agreeing with measurement to 0.12% at tree level and 0.001% after the Schwinger one-loop correction $\alpha/(2\pi)$. Read for *breadth*, the same topology yields the fine-structure constant: $1/\alpha = 1+2k(k^2+1)+1/[k(k+d)] = 137.036$, matching the CODATA value to 0.00021%.

Five additional results follow with zero free parameters: the force hierarchy $\alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}$ from 21 gravitational versus one electromagnetic coupling level; the dark matter interpolating function $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ from detailed balance at the field closure boundary, with a_0 matching observation to 0.41%; all five bimetric β_n coupling constants determined as $(1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$; $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc, between the Planck and SH0ES values; and m_e to 0.1% from a derived mass-closure identity.

The topology also yields the inverse square law, $E = mc^2$, spin $\hbar/2$, and energy quantization as structural consequences. Every integer in G and $1/\alpha$ traces to a named quantity in established bimetric gravity. The single discrete input is $d = 3$ spatial dimensions; no continuous parameters are adjusted. The cosmological constant, strong force, and weak force are not addressed.

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I. INTRODUCTION

The fundamental constants of physics have been measured with extraordinary precision. Newton's gravitational constant G has been the subject of increasingly refined experiments since Cavendish's 1798 torsion balance measurement, yet for over three centuries no theory has calculated its value from first principles. The Standard Model of particle physics requires over two dozen such parameters [19], each determined by experiment but not derived from any deeper principle. That these constants take the values they do is what makes atoms stable, chemistry possible, and structure viable at every scale. Explaining why they take precisely these values has remained one of the deepest open questions in physics.

The stakes extend beyond unexplained constants. Galactic rotation curves, gravitational lensing, and the cosmic microwave background all indicate that approximately 85% of the universe's gravitating mass has never been directly detected [19]. Four decades of dedicated searches have produced no confirmed dark matter particle. The assumption underlying standard cosmology is that spacetime is a structureless continuum whose gravitational response is fully characterized by a single constant, G. But if the gravitational field possesses internal coupling structure that modifies its response at different scales, the question changes: is the missing 85% missing mass, or is it missing structure?

In other branches of physics, the relationship between internal topology and observable properties is well established. The molecular lattice of a ruby crystal determines the discrete energy levels available to electrons passing through it; the result is stimulated emission, the physical basis of the laser. Semiconductor band gaps, superconducting transition temperatures, and phonon spectra all follow from the coupling architecture of their respective lattices. In each case, the internal topology of the medium determines the measurable constants that describe it. Just as the angles of a crystal are determined by its lattice, the constants of nature may be determined by the topology of the gravitational field. They would not be free parameters that could have been different; they would be structural consequences of living in three spatial dimensions.

Gravity, too, possesses an internal coupling structure. The tetrad formalism [9, 10] defines the "square root of the metric," $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab}\, e^a_\mu\, e^b_\nu$, decomposing each metric into a local frame whose spatial triad defines a tetrahedron [27], the minimal solid in three dimensions. Ghost-

free bimetric gravity [6, 28] operates with two such tetrad fields, $g = E^T \eta\, E$ and $f = L^T \eta\, L$, coupled at a single interaction vertex through a potential with five free coefficients β_0 through β_4. Ghost-freedom requires opposite spatial orientations for the two tetrads [2]; general covariance requires them to share compatible (3+1) decompositions [29]. Together, these constraints define a dual tetrahedron field topology whose field coupling hierarchy has not been systematically read out. This paper reads that hierarchy and shows what it produces.

Gravity occupies a unique position among the fundamental interactions: it is not a field on a background spacetime but the dynamical spacetime itself, and it must therefore be self-consistent at every point with no external structure to enforce coherence. General relativity encodes this through the non-degeneracy of the metric ($\det(g) \neq 0$), which requires the field to achieve *field closure*: to define a complete coupling structure at every point, with no gaps and no missing directions. Field closure forces the field to develop internal architecture, creating the field chambers through which neighboring field regions interact.

The physical picture begins with field packing. Gravitational field regions, being distributed and locally coupled, pack in three dimensions. The simplex theorem establishes that $k = 4$ faces are both necessary and sufficient to enclose a volume in three dimensions, and these four faces define a tetrahedral field chamber, the minimal solid enclosing the coupling region. A single tetrahedral field chamber, however, is not self-consistent. Four independent results from the literature, spanning five decades and over 2,300 combined citations, all demonstrate this: spinor theory demands the SL(2,$\mathbb{C}$) double cover [3, 4]; Ashtekar's chiral decomposition requires both self-dual and anti-self-dual connections [5]; ghost-free bimetric gravity requires two dynamical metrics [6]; and stability analysis confirms that a single orientation produces a scalar ghost [2]. Self-consistency requires a second tetrahedron with opposite orientation, coupled to the first at a shared center: the Field Origin. The resulting structure, two interlocking tetrahedra sharing a common center, is the stellated octahedron [1].

The field coupling structure of this stellated octahedron is a polynomial in $k = (3{+}1) = 4$:

$$f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 \tag{1}$$

whose three terms correspond to structures already recognized in the literature: the Field Origin (1) [28], the vierbein face ($k = 4$) [9], and the full bimetric field coupling ($k^2 = 16$) [6]. The stellated octahedron has three structural regions (TetA, the Field Origin, TetB), and

evaluating $f(k)$ in each yields three integers: $f(4) = 21$ (the full coupling depth), $f(4)|_{s=0} = 17$ (the coupling capacity at the Field Origin), and $f(4)|_{s=-1} = 13$ (the spatial structure of the inverted sector). These three integers, together with the quantum scale $\hbar c/m_e^2$, determine G:

$$G = \frac{17}{13} \times \alpha^{21} \times \frac{\hbar c}{m_e^2} \tag{2}$$

Topology: $G_{\text{topo}} = 6.666 \times 10^{-11}\ \text{m}^3\,\text{kg}^{-1}\,\text{s}^{-2}$

Measured: $G_{\text{CODATA}} = 6.674 \times 10^{-11}\ \text{m}^3\,\text{kg}^{-1}\,\text{s}^{-2}$ [18]

Agreement: 0.12% at tree level; 0.001% at one loop. Not fitted.

The polynomial is not fitted to G. It is the field coupling structure that the stellated octahedron's topology requires. The entire framework rests on a single discrete fact: space has three dimensions ($d = 3$). From this one input, every other number follows through geometry, linear algebra, and dimensional analysis. Zero free parameters are adjusted. The test is simple: start from $d = 3$, follow the chain, and if any single prediction disagrees with measurement, the framework fails without adjustment. There are no dials to turn.

If this field topology derives G, does it also explain other fundamental relationships? The answer, developed in Sections V through X, is that the same dual tetrahedron field topology produces quantitative results across classical, relativistic, and quantum physics. The inverse square law follows from field spreading in three dimensions. Mass-energy equivalence follows from the bimetric field structure and its two closure speeds. The force hierarchy follows from the depth of field coupling within the 21-level structure. Electron spin $\hbar/2$ follows from the face ratio of the stellated octahedron. The dark matter problem is resolved by the constitutive law that field closure imposes. These are not separate explanations for separate phenomena. They are aspects of one field topology, the topology that yields G.

A. Scope and Limits

This paper presents what the dual tetrahedron topology explains about fundamental physics. It does not claim to explain everything. The fine-structure constant α is derived in Section VI from the Hamiltonian interaction states of the bimetric topology, yielding $1/\alpha = 137.036$ to

0.00021%. The electron mass m_e is derived in Section IX from the exactly determined closure system. No particle-physics input is required; the Hubble constant H enters as a cosmological observable and is itself predicted by the topology (Section VII B). The cosmological constant, the strong force, and the weak force are not directly addressed. The goal is clarity about what the topology does explain, not a claim to have solved all of physics.

B. Overview

Section II establishes the theoretical foundations: LIGO confirms gravitational propagation, the wave equation requires neighbors, and field closure is what GR already enforces through non-degeneracy. Section III reviews the dual tetrahedron topological structure from which the derivations follow. Section IV develops the coupling polynomial, the heart of the paper. Section V derives the fundamental equations: G from tetrad coupling, the inverse square law, mass-energy equivalence, the force hierarchy, and quantum consistency. Section VI derives the fine-structure constant. Section VII resolves the dark matter problem and predicts the Hubble constant. Section VIII presents the covariant completion. Section IX derives the electron mass. Section X presents the precision context, distinctive predictions, and the complete dependency chain.

II. WHY GRAVITY HAS TOPOLOGY

This section establishes that topology is not an addition to general relativity but what GR already requires. The gravitational field propagates (LIGO confirmed this in 2015). Propagation requires neighbors (the wave equation demands it). And neighbors that must be self-consistent at every point, with no external structure to enforce coherence, must achieve field closure (GR has enforced this for a century through non-degeneracy). Once there is structure, counting begins. Numbers emerge from counting, not from fitting. Everything that follows in this paper is an exercise in counting the right geometric object.

A. The Gravitational Field Propagates

General Relativity describes gravity through the metric tensor $g_{\mu\nu}$, a dynamical field satisfying Einstein's equations. This is standard physics, confirmed by a century of observations. GR works beautifully. But when we ask how the gravitational field couples to itself, how one region of spacetime influences its neighbors, the answer lies in a reformulation that many physicists learn but few fully explore: tetrad gravity.

Tetrad gravity, also called vierbein or frame-field gravity, is textbook material [9, 10]. It describes the same physics as metric GR but makes the field's internal structure explicit. The tetrad is defined as the "square root of the metric": the decomposition $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab}\, e^a_\mu\, e^b_\nu$ expresses the metric as the inner product of two copies of the tetrad field. In the (3+1) decomposition, the three spacelike legs of the tetrad (the spatial triad) define a tetrahedron [27], the minimal solid in three dimensions. Each spacetime point carries a local frame of four basis vectors from a common origin, and these frames couple to neighboring frames through shared boundary faces. This coupling structure is the field's *topology*. The mathematics has been in graduate textbooks for decades, yet the physical implications of this topology remain underappreciated.

Why does gravity, uniquely among the fundamental interactions, require us to ask about its internal structure? Because gravity is not a field that lives *on* spacetime. Gravity *is* spacetime. The electromagnetic field inherits its topology from the background metric: it knows what "neighbors" means because spacetime tells it. But the gravitational field is the metric itself. It cannot borrow structure from a background, because it is the background. If the field must be self-consistent and no external structure exists to enforce that consistency, the field must provide its own closure mechanism. This is the physical content of background independence, one of GR's deepest features.

LIGO's first detection of gravitational waves in September 2015, which earned the 2017 Nobel Prize in Physics, confirmed that gravity propagates as a wave through locally-coupled structure. The subsequent detection on August 17, 2017, when LIGO and Virgo observed gravitational waves from a neutron star merger arriving 1.7 seconds before the gamma-ray burst [8], confirmed this structure with multi-messenger precision. The gravitational field has spatially distributed, locally-coupled degrees of freedom: the disturbance propagated

from point to point, each region of the field influencing its neighbors across 130 million light-years.

The ocean makes this concrete. Water waves propagate because water molecules push their neighbors; the disturbance passes from molecule to molecule across thousands of kilometers. Water molecules must form closed electron shells, and this closure creates tetrahedral hydrogen-bonding structures, the same four-fold topology that appears in tetrad gravity. In both systems, three independent spatial directions from a common origin define a tetrahedron: field closure in three dimensions requires no fewer than four faces.

The wave equation encodes this requirement mathematically. Gravitational perturbations satisfy:

$$\frac{\partial^2 h}{\partial t^2} = c^2 \nabla^2 h \tag{3}$$

The Laplacian ∇^2 appears on the right-hand side. By definition, this operator requires evaluating the field at neighboring points:

$$\nabla^2 \Phi = \lim_{\epsilon \to 0} \frac{\Phi(x+\epsilon) + \Phi(x-\epsilon) - 2\Phi(x)}{\epsilon^2} \tag{4}$$

The logic is inescapable: gravitational waves propagate (LIGO observed this). Propagation requires ∇^2 (the wave equation (3) demands it). ∇^2 requires neighbors (by definition). Therefore, gravity must consist of distributed, locally-coupled degrees of freedom. Figure 1 illustrates this schematically: each field region overlaps with its immediate neighbors, coupling through shared field volume, and the pattern of these couplings constitutes the field's topology.

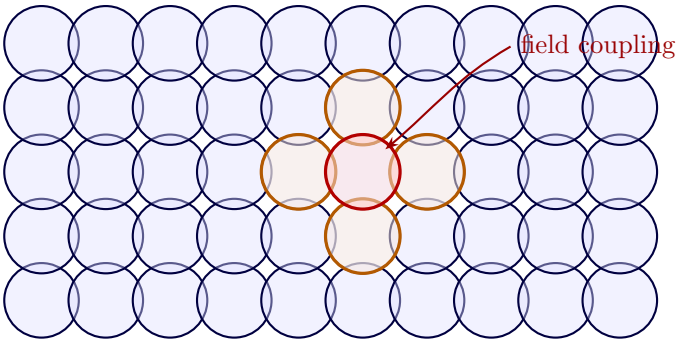


FIG. 1. Two-dimensional cross-section illustrating the coupling topology of gravitational field regions. Each circle represents a field region; where adjacent regions overlap (red shading), the fields couple through shared volume. One interior region (red) and its $k = 4$ nearest neighbors (orange) are highlighted, with the four coupling zones visible as lens-shaped intersections. In three spatial dimensions, the simplex theorem (Section II C) requires $k = d + 1 = 4$ coupling faces per region; these four coupled faces enclose a tetrahedral volume, the field chamber.

The question is not *whether* gravity has topology; LIGO and tetrad theory both confirm it does. The question is: *what is* that topology?

B. Field Closure: The Requirement GR Already Enforces

If gravity consists of distributed, locally-coupled degrees of freedom, how do these degrees of freedom achieve consistency?

Consider what "locally-coupled" means. At each point, the field must define a local reference frame: which direction is timelike, which directions are spacelike. Neighboring points must agree on how their frames relate. If point A says "my timelike direction points this way" and neighboring point B says "that same direction is spacelike," physics would be undefined at the boundary.

For the field to be well-defined everywhere, the local frames must form a complete, non-singular structure. At every point, all four directions (one time, three space) must be specified. No direction can be missing; no direction can be collapsed. This requirement, that the frame structure be complete everywhere, is what we call **field closure**.

This is not a new requirement. General Relativity has enforced it for a century, using different language. In metric GR, the condition is called non-degeneracy: $\det(g_{\mu\nu}) \neq 0$. Without this condition, the inverse metric $g^{\mu\nu}$ is undefined, indices cannot be raised, and the field equations cannot be written. Field closure and non-degeneracy are two names for the same physics.

The tetrad formalism reveals what this condition means geometrically [9, 10]. The equivalence principle requires physics to be locally Minkowski at every point:

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab}\, e^a_\mu\, e^b_\nu \tag{5}$$

where $\eta_{ab} = \mathrm{diag}(-1, +1, +1, +1)$ is the Minkowski metric and e^a_μ are four orthonormal basis vectors defining the local frame. Taking determinants:

$$\det(g) = -[\det(e)]^2 \tag{6}$$

Therefore $\det(g) \neq 0$ if and only if $\det(e) \neq 0$: the four tetrad legs must span the tangent space completely. **GR's non-degeneracy condition and field closure are mathematically equivalent.**

In simplicial quantum gravity, Barbieri [27] showed that the analogous closure constraint (four face normals summing to zero) uniquely defines a tetrahedron at each node of the gravitational field. The continuous condition $\det(e) \neq 0$ and the discrete condition $\sum \vec{n}_i = 0$ are two expressions of the same geometric requirement: four independent directions must span a complete structure.

Concept	**GR Language**	**Tetrad Language**
Field defined everywhere	Non-degenerate metric	Field closure
Mathematical condition	$\det(g) \neq 0$	$\det(e) \neq 0$
Structure	3+1 decomposition	4 tetrad legs
Constraints	4 ADM equations	4 projections onto legs

TABLE I. GR non-degeneracy and field closure are two names for the same requirement. Practitioners of General Relativity have enforced field closure for a century.

Field closure is the spark plug of the framework: a binary condition. Either the field encloses

volume ($\det(e) \neq 0$) or spacetime has collapsed ($\det(e) = 0$). This is the $k^0 = 1$ term in the coupling polynomial (Section IV). It is always on, independent of direction, orientation, or dynamics. It is the precondition for everything else.

Field closure converts a qualitative demand ("spacetime must not degenerate") into a quantitative constraint: how many faces must a local field region have to guarantee enclosure in d dimensions? The answer is $d + 1$, which leads directly to k.

C. Why $k = 4$: The Uniqueness of Four

Before examining the mathematics, consider what $k = 4$ means physically. The parameter k counts how many neighbors each field region must touch to achieve field closure. In three-dimensional space, what is the minimum number of neighbors required to enclose a region?

Nature answers this question everywhere we look. Stack oranges at a grocery store: in close-packing each orange touches 12 neighbors, but the gaps between groups of three touching spheres form tetrahedral pockets, the simplest three-dimensional cavities. Examine water molecules: each forms hydrogen bonds with up to four neighbors, creating the tetrahedral network that gives water its remarkable properties. Study crystal structures: atoms pack in arrangements where tetrahedral coordination dominates. In 1611, Kepler conjectured that spheres in three dimensions pack most efficiently in arrangements with tetrahedral local structure; Thomas Hales proved this rigorously in 1998 [13]. Four-fold coordination is not a choice. It is what three-dimensional space requires for efficient packing.

The simplex theorem [12] formalizes this observation: the minimum convex polytope enclosing volume in d dimensions has $d + 1$ faces. For $d = 3$ spatial dimensions, this gives 4 faces: a tetrahedron. The tetrahedron is the simplest possible three-dimensional container. Just as a triangle is the minimum polygon in 2D (you cannot enclose area with fewer than 3 sides), a tetrahedron is the minimum polyhedron in 3D (you cannot enclose volume with fewer than 4 faces). The tetrahedron is to 3D gravity what the triangle is to 2D tiling: you do not choose it; three dimensions force it.

The value $k = 4$ is squeezed from both sides by independent constraints:

From below ($k \geq 4$): Fewer than 4 constraints cannot close a 3D evolution problem. The

simplex theorem establishes this geometrically: minimal enclosure in d dimensions requires $d+1$ boundary conditions.

From above ($k \leq 4$): The symmetric metric tensor in four dimensions has 10 independent components. The k constraint equations and k gauge freedoms together remove $2k$ components, leaving $10-2k$ propagating degrees of freedom. LIGO measured exactly two graviton polarizations [8]. For $k=4$, this gives $10-8=2$, matching observation. With $k=5$ or higher, $10-2k<2$: fewer than 2 propagating modes, violating the observation that gravity propagates.

Combining: $k \geq 4$ (field closure) and $k \leq 4$ (graviton polarizations). The only solution is $k=4$.

D. Why $d=3$: The Tiling Condition

The preceding subsection established $k=d+1$. This subsection establishes why $d=3$, removing the last degree of freedom.

The dual tetrahedron structure requires two simplices to tile a region of space. The face count of two simplices in d dimensions is $2(d+1)$, which grows linearly. The vertex count of the dual lattice is 2^d, which grows exponentially. For the dual structure to close consistently, these two counts must match:

$$2(d+1) = 2^d \tag{7}$$

Evaluating for small d: $d=1$ gives $4 \neq 2$; $d=2$ gives $6 \neq 4$; $d=3$ gives $8=8$; $d=4$ gives $10 \neq 16$. The linear and exponential functions cross at exactly one integer: $d=3$. This is arithmetic, not fitting.

Two additional constraints independently select $d=3$:

Orbital stability. Bertrand's theorem [20] establishes that closed orbits exist only for $1/r^2$ and r^2 force laws. In d spatial dimensions, the gravitational force falls as $1/r^{d-1}$. Closed orbits require $d-1=2$, hence $d=3$. In $d \geq 4$ dimensions, orbits are unstable: small perturbations send planets spiraling inward or outward.

Atomic stability. In d spatial dimensions, the hydrogen atom has no bound states for $d \geq 4$: the centrifugal barrier cannot prevent collapse of the electron into the nucleus.

Stable matter requires $d \leq 3$.

Three different domains of physics, topological tiling, orbital mechanics, and quantum stability, intersect at one value. The dimension d is not a parameter; it is an intersection point. Parameters can be adjusted. The intersection of three constraints cannot.

E. The Characteristic Scale

The tetrad formalism specifies topology ($k = 4$ faces) but not scale. At what physical radius does this internal structure exist?

Two independent routes converge on the same characteristic length:

Route 1: Electromagnetic Stability. At some critical radius, the energy stored in the electron's electric field equals its rest mass energy $m_e c^2$. The radius where these two energies balance is the classical electron radius [15]:

$$r_e = \frac{e^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 m_e c^2} = 2.818 \times 10^{-15} \text{ m} \tag{8}$$

This calculation uses only electromagnetism (e, ε_0) and special relativity (c). No gravity. No cosmology.

Route 2: Gravitational Topology. When gravity couples through the dual tetrahedron structure, all $k^2 = 16$ coupling channels engage (Section IV A). The characteristic radius emerges when the tetrad's gravitational acceleration equals the cosmic threshold a_0:

$$r_e = k\sqrt{\frac{Gm_e}{a_0}} = 2.82 \times 10^{-15} \text{ m} \tag{9}$$

This calculation uses gravity (G), cosmology (a_0), and topology ($k = 4$). No electromagnetism.

Route	**Constants used**	**Result**	**Domain**
EM stability	e, ε_0, m_e, c	$r_e = 2.818$ fm	Electromagnetism
Cosmic topology	G, H, m_e, k, c	$r_e = 2.82$ fm	Gravity + Cosmology

TABLE II. Two independent routes converge on the same scale to 0.21%.

Match: **0.21%**. Two independent domains of physics, using different constants and different reasoning, converge on the same scale. If the same topology governs both gravity and electromagnetism, the characteristic scale must be shared. The fact that it is confirms the hypothesis quantitatively.

Once the scale is identified, the fine-structure constant becomes geometric:

$$\alpha = \frac{r_e}{\bar{\lambda}_C} \qquad \text{where } \bar{\lambda}_C = \frac{\hbar}{m_e c} \tag{10}$$

Alpha is the ratio of the field scale (where the topology lives) to the quantum scale (where coherence sets the wavelength). It is the lattice spacing divided by the quantum coherence length. Alpha is not a running coupling that happens to be near 1/137; it is a topological ratio.

Summary. The theoretical foundations are established in the literature: the gravitational field propagates (LIGO), propagation requires field topology (wave equation), field topology requires field closure (non-degeneracy), field closure requires $k = 4$ faces (simplex theorem), the spatial dimension is $d = 3$ (tiling condition, orbital stability, atomic stability), and the scale is the electron radius (convergence). What remains is to show the structure that these constraints produce, and what it yields.

III. THE DUAL TETRAHEDRON

Section II established that field closure requires $k = 4$ faces and $d = 3$ spatial dimensions. A single tetrahedron satisfies the face count, but not the consistency requirements. This section shows that four independent arguments require a second tetrahedron with opposite orientation, introduces the Field Origin where they couple, and derives the face structure and geometric elements that determine the coupling hierarchy.

A. Four Roads to Two Tetrahedra

Section II established that field closure requires $k = 4$ faces and $d = 3$ spatial dimensions. A single tetrahedron satisfies the face count. But is a single tetrahedron sufficient for a

consistent gravitational field? Four independent arguments from the literature, spanning five decades and over 2,300 combined citations, all establish that it is not:

1. **Stability** (Alexander, Marcianò, Smolin 2014 [2]): A single tetrahedral field chamber has a preferred direction, an apex pointing somewhere. This asymmetry produces a *ghost*: a field mode with negative kinetic energy that destabilizes the vacuum. Two opposite field chambers cancel the asymmetry, and the ghost disappears.

2. **Spinor structure** (Weinberg 1995 [3]; Geroch 1968 [4]): Fermions require the SL(2,$\mathbb{C}$) double cover of the Lorentz group. Rotating a fermion 360 degrees does not return it to its original state; a full 720-degree rotation is needed. This is bimetric structure: one 360-degree rotation brings TetA back into alignment but leaves TetB out of phase; the second rotation realigns both. Each tetrahedron realizes one sheet of the double cover.

3. **Chirality** (Ashtekar 1986 [5]): Gravity decomposes into self-dual and anti-self-dual components, $A^+ \oplus A^-$, like left-handed and right-handed gloves that are mirror images but cannot be superimposed. Full gravitational field closure requires both halves. Each half corresponds to one tetrahedron.

4. **Bimetric gravity** (Hassan, Rosen 2012 [6]; Hinterbichler, Rosen 2012 [28]): Ghost-free bimetric gravity requires two dynamical metrics, each decomposed into its own tetrad field: $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab}\, E^a_\mu\, E^b_\nu$ and $f_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{ab}\, L^a_\mu\, L^b_\nu$. The spatial triad of each tetrad defines a tetrahedron [27]; two tetrads define two tetrahedra. The two fields couple through an interaction potential $V(\mathcal{S}) = \sum_{n=0}^{4} \beta_n\, e_n(\mathcal{S})$, where $\mathcal{S} = \sqrt{g^{-1} f}$ is a 4×4 matrix and β_0 through β_4 are free coefficients [6]. Hassan and Kocic [29] proved that the two metrics must share compatible (3+1) decompositions. The theory is ghost-free at the full nonlinear level, with seven propagating degrees of freedom.

When four independent roads converge on the same destination, the destination is not hypothesized. These are textbook results from different subfields: stability analysis, quantum field theory, canonical gravity, and massive gravity. All four independently require the same field topology: two tetrahedra with opposite orientations, coupled at a shared center, the Field Origin.

Each argument constrains the structure in a specific way. Stability constrains *orientation*: the tetrahedra must point in opposite directions. Spinor structure constrains *topology*: the two tetrahedra must be genuinely distinct, realizing the two sheets of the SL(2,$\mathbb{C}$) double cover. Chirality constrains *completeness*: each tetrahedron carries one half of gravity. Bimetric structure constrains *interaction*: the two tetrad fields must couple at a single Field Origin [28], with opposite spatial orientations, because same-orientation coupling produces the Boulware-Deser ghost [14].

Together, these constraints uniquely determine the arrangement: two tetrahedra, opposite orientations, interpenetrating so that each vertex of one lies at the center of a face of the other. This is the stellated octahedron [1], the unique compound of two tetrahedra satisfying all four requirements. The resulting figure has:

- 8 vertices (4 from each tetrahedron)
- 12 edges (6 from each tetrahedron)
- 8 triangular faces (4 from each tetrahedron)
- A central octahedral region where the two tetrahedra overlap
- Inversion symmetry: reflecting any point through the center ($\mathbf{r} \to -\mathbf{r}$) maps the structure onto itself, exchanging TetA and TetB

These 28 geometric elements ($8 + 12 + 8$) constitute the complete topological scaffold. This count will prove significant when the coupling hierarchy is read for its total breadth rather than its depth (Section VI).

Other arrangements, tetrahedra side by side, apex to apex, or partially overlapping, either break the central symmetry required by bimetric gravity or fail to provide the complete spinor doubling. Only the stellated octahedron has both the dual orientation needed for stability and the shared coupling point needed for bimetric interaction. The structure is not chosen; it is required.

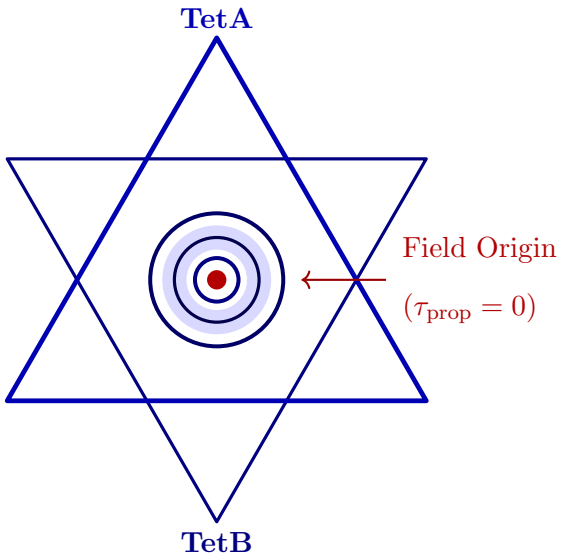


FIG. 2. The stellated octahedron (Dual Tetrahedron): two tetrahedra with opposite orientations sharing a common center. TetA (thick lines) points upward; TetB (thinner lines) points downward. The structure has 28 geometric elements: 8 vertices, 12 edges, and 8 faces. At the geometric center lies the Field Origin, where the two spacetime sectors couple. This is the dual tetrad topology from which the fundamental equations derive.

B. The Field Origin

Bimetric gravity requires that two dynamical metrics interact. The Hassan-Rosen formulation [6] and the vielbein extension by Deffayet, Mourad, and Zahariade [7] establish that the two spin-2 fields must couple at a shared spacetime point, what the literature calls an *interaction vertex*. Without such a vertex, the two metrics would be causally disconnected: two separate gravitational fields with no physical relationship. We call this point the **Field Origin**.

The stellated octahedron provides exactly this Field Origin. At the geometric center, equidistant from all eight vertices, the two tetrahedra share a single point. This is where the two spacetime sectors meet, where information from one tetrahedron can couple to the other.

Think of the Field Origin as the neck of an hourglass. Sand flows from one chamber through the neck into the other; nothing can pass between the two halves except through that single constriction. The Field Origin is the topological bottleneck through which all coupling

between TetA and TetB must pass.

Why does time vanish at this point? Consider the light-travel time from the coupling center to any point at distance r:

$$\tau_{\text{prop}} = \frac{r}{c} \tag{11}$$

At the center itself, $r = 0$, so $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0/c = 0$. The propagation time vanishes. But this equation says more than "time is zero here." Read in the other direction, $\tau_{\text{prop}} = r/c$ means time *increases* with distance from the origin. Time radiates outward. The Field Origin is not merely a point where time happens to vanish; it is the source from which all temporal separation emerges. The analogy is the eye of a hurricane: perfectly still, yet generating the entire storm.

This property is what makes the Field Origin physically meaningful. The two tetrahedra represent two separate spacetime sectors with opposite orientations. For ghost-free coupling, they must meet at a point where their interaction can be instantaneous, unmediated by propagation delay. The Field Origin, where $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$, satisfies this requirement.

Why everything spins

One of the deepest questions in physics: why does everything rotate? Stars spin. Galaxies spin. Electrons spin. Angular momentum pervades the universe at every scale.

Einstein-Cartan theory, developed in 1922, provides a hint [16]. Cartan showed that spacetime geometry and intrinsic spin are intimately connected: the spin of matter couples directly to spacetime torsion. Where there is torsion, there is spin. Where there is spin, there is torsion.

The dual tetrahedral field structure makes this connection concrete. When two tetrahedra with opposite orientations couple at a shared point, they create a continuous rotational field topology. Consider the analogy of water flowing in a river whirlpool (Figure 3, left panel). At the surface, water spirals inward. As it approaches the center, it accelerates, passes through the central axis, and disperses below. The vortex core is not where motion stops; it is where rotation vanishes but through-flow continues.

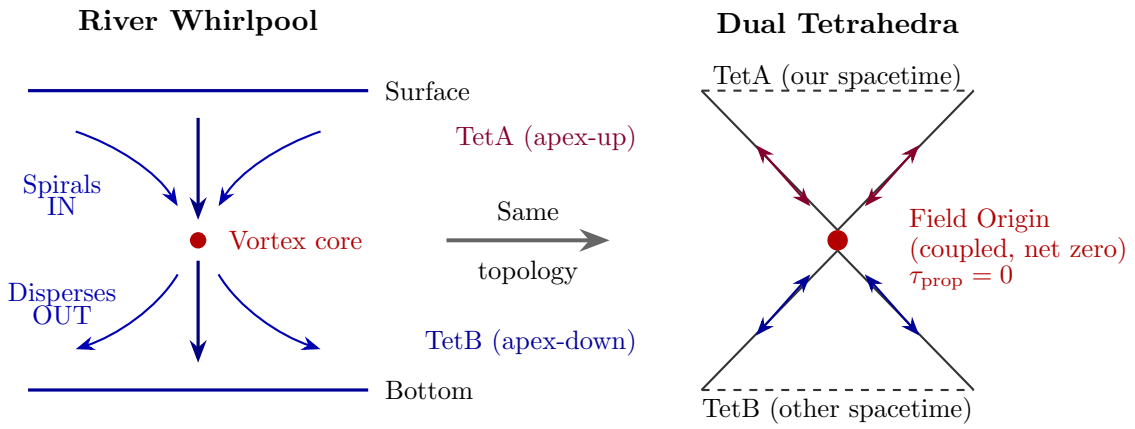


FIG. 3. The Field Origin as a vortex core. **Left:** A river whirlpool viewed from the side. Water spirals inward at the surface, passes through the vortex core, and disperses below. **Right:** The dual tetrahedral field structure. TetA (purple, top) with apex-up orientation, the Field Origin (red, center) at the coupling point where $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$, and TetB (blue, bottom) with apex-down orientation. Angular momentum does not stop at the Field Origin but flows through it.

The dual tetrahedral field structure shares this vortex topology. Angular momentum propagates through both spacetime sectors, passing through the Field Origin that connects them. At the Field Origin itself, the rotational component vanishes (because $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$ there), yet angular momentum continues through. This is the topological origin of spin: angular momentum flowing through the neck of the hourglass.

How much angular momentum passes through this vortex eye? The answer depends on the internal face structure of the stellated octahedron. Spin lives at the Field Origin, and its value is determined by the partition of faces between the two tetrahedral sectors. Angular momentum divides 3:2:3 across TetA (3/8), the Field Origin (2/8), and TetB (3/8). The fraction flowing through the Field Origin is $(2/8) \times 2\hbar = \hbar/2$. Spin is not a property added to matter from outside. It is the angular momentum flowing through the topological connection between the two tetrahedra. Section III C develops this in full.

C. The Face Structure and Spin

The 3+1 split of spacetime is often treated as a coordinate choice, a matter of convenience for the ADM formalism. In the stellated octahedron, it is a counting fact about the solid.

The faces tell us what spacetime is made of.

Each tetrahedron has 4 triangular faces. The stellated octahedron, composed of two interlocking tetrahedra, therefore has 8 faces in total. These 8 faces divide into two types based on their orientation relative to the Field Origin:

- **TIME faces** (2 total): In each tetrahedron, the face opposite the apex points inward, toward the geometric center where the Field Origin lies. The base of TetA (apex-up) faces downward toward the center, and the base of TetB (apex-down) faces upward toward the center. These two faces point toward the coupling point where $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$. They are called TIME faces because they connect to the temporal origin.
- **SPATIAL faces** (6 total): The remaining three faces of each tetrahedron share the apex vertex and point outward, away from the Field Origin into the spatial dimensions. Three faces from TetA radiate upward and outward; three faces from TetB radiate downward and outward.

Why exactly 2 faces point inward is a geometric fact, not a parameter. A tetrahedron has one apex and one base. The base, the single face opposite the apex, points toward the center of the stellated octahedron. The other three faces share the apex and point away. With two tetrahedra, two bases point inward and six apex-sharing faces point outward. The ratio 6:2 (spatial:temporal) is the geometric origin of spacetime's (3+1) signature. It is a counting fact about the solid, not a postulate about spacetime.

Electron spin from the same topology

The face structure determines not only the signature of spacetime but also the spin of the fundamental fermion. Spin is computed from the topology, not added as an external quantum number.

Route 1: The face ratio. The stellated octahedron has 8 faces: 2 TIME faces pointing inward toward the Field Origin, 6 SPATIAL faces pointing outward. Each tetrahedron carries quantized angular momentum $\hbar$ (one closed circuit through 4 faces); the stellated octahedron carries total angular momentum $2\hbar$. Only the 2 TIME faces point toward the

vortex eye; the 6 SPATIAL faces carry orbital angular momentum that does not pass through the Field Origin. The observable intrinsic spin is:

$$S = \frac{N_{\text{TIME}}}{N_{\text{total}}} \times L_{\text{total}} = \frac{2}{8} \times 2\hbar = \frac{\hbar}{2} \tag{12}$$

This is the vortex aperture argument: the Field Origin admits angular momentum only through the 2 faces that point toward it.

Route 2: The structural state differences. The structural states (Section IV C) reveal a second, independent path. In TetA ($s = +1$), the full hierarchy has 21 field coupling levels. At the Field Origin ($s = 0$), 17 remain. The $21 - 17 = 4$ that vanish are the face channels that require spatial extent. Similarly, $17 - 13 = 4$ channels belong to TetB's sector. The total face contribution across both sectors is $4 + 4 = 8 = 2k$. An observer in our (3+1) spacetime has access to only one sector's face channels: 4 of the 8. With quantized angular momentum $\hbar$ per closed circuit through k faces:

$$S = \frac{k}{2k} \times \hbar = \frac{4}{8} \times \hbar = \frac{\hbar}{2} \tag{13}$$

Two independent readings of the same field topology, one topological (counting faces) and one algebraic (counting coupling channels from the polynomial), both yield $\hbar/2$. The intermediate numbers differ (2/8 versus 4/8, $2\hbar$ versus $\hbar$), but both arrive at $\hbar/2$. Their agreement from independent starting points is a self-consistency check on the topology. The 1/2 follows from the bimetric structure: an observer occupies one of two coupled spacetime sectors.

Calibration note. Both routes assume that the total angular momentum per closed circuit is $\hbar$, the experimentally established quantum of angular momentum. The topology determines the fraction (1/2); the magnitude $\hbar$ is an empirical input, not derived here.

D. The 28 Geometric Elements

Count what you can build from the stellated octahedron. The answer is 28, and this number enters the most precisely measured constant in physics.

The total count of geometric elements is:

$$V + E + F = 8 + 12 + 8 = 28 \tag{14}$$

This can be verified by building a physical model. Eight vertices, twelve edges, eight triangular faces. The count is geometry, not conjecture.

What makes 28 significant is not that it appears once but that it appears three times, from three independent countings:

Counting 1: Geometric elements. As above, $V + E + F = 8 + 12 + 8 = 28$. This counts every distinct structural feature of the stellated octahedron.

Counting 2: Face-channels. Each of the 8 faces of the stellated octahedron has $k - 1 = 3$ independent coupling channels (a triangular face has 3 vertices, and excluding the Field Origin leaves $k - 1$). But the 2 TIME faces are shared between sectors and contribute a single coupling each. An effective count gives 7 independent face types times 4 channels per face type: $7 \times 4 = 28$. More precisely, $k(k + d) = 4 \times 7 = 28$, where $k + d = 7$ is the number of effective face modes.

Counting 3: Bimetric degrees of freedom. Ghost-free bimetric gravity has 7 propagating degrees of freedom (2 from a massless graviton, 5 from a massive graviton). Each propagating mode phase-locks across 4 face channels: $7 \times 4 = 28$.

Three different enumerations, geometric, face-based, and dynamical, all yield 28. This triple convergence is an algebraic identity: $V + E + F = k(k + d)$ for the compound of two simplices in d dimensions. It is not a coincidence to be explained away; it is the statement that the geometric scaffold, the face coupling structure, and the dynamical degrees of freedom all describe the same object counted from different perspectives.

This number enters the fine-structure constant. The fractional part of $1/\alpha$ is:

$$\frac{1}{\alpha} = 137 + \frac{1}{28} = 137.0357\ldots \tag{15}$$

The most precisely measured constant in physics carries, in its decimal tail, the element count of the stellated octahedron. Section VI derives this in full. When the fraction is derived from geometry and matches measurement to 0.00021%, the geometry is telling the truth.

IV. THE COUPLING POLYNOMIAL

Section III established the dual tetrahedron: two interlocking tetrahedra sharing a Field Origin. This section develops the coupling polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$, the mathematical heart of the paper. The polynomial counts the depth of field coupling within the stellated octahedron: how many levels the gravitational field must traverse to achieve complete coupling between the two sectors. Every derivation in subsequent sections flows from this polynomial and the three integers it produces.

A. Why the Polynomial Has Three Terms

Field coupling between the two tetrahedra does not happen all at once. It has levels, each contributing to the total interaction strength. Consider what must connect for gravity to operate. The answer is a causal sequence: you cannot propagate what does not exist, and you cannot interact without first reaching. The polynomial's three terms are not a mathematical convenience; they are the three stages of this causal chain.

1. **EXIST: The Field Origin ($k^0 = 1$).** Field coupling begins at the origin, where the two tetrahedra meet. This is the foundation: without the Field Origin, there is no coupling at all. This term is binary: either the field encloses volume ($\det(e) \neq 0$) or spacetime has collapsed ($\det(e) = 0$). It is always on, independent of direction, orientation, or dynamics.

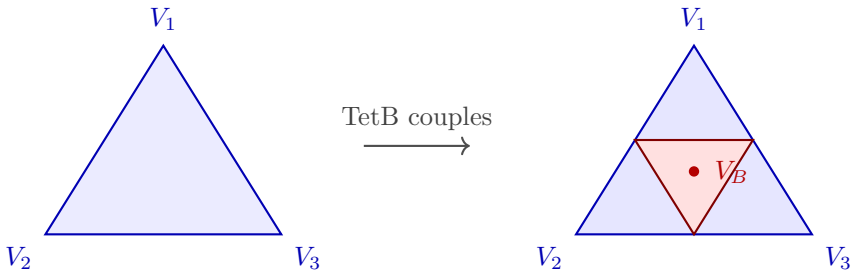
2. **PROPAGATE: One coupled face ($k^1 = 4$).** From the Field Origin, the field propagates through one face of the tetrahedron, which subdivides into $3 + 1 = 4$ sub-regions (three spatial, one coupling) as shown in Figure 4. This is how the field extends through one sector of the dual tetrahedral field chamber.

3. **INTERACT: The full bimetric Field Coupling ($k^2 = 16$).** Both tetrahedra interact fully. Each has (3+1) dimensions, so the complete field coupling space is (3+1) $\times$ (3+1) = 16-dimensional. This is the 4×4 frame transition matrix $\mathcal{S}$ of Hassan-Rosen bimetric gravity [6].

The causal ordering is forced: EXIST before PROPAGATE before INTERACT. You cannot propagate what does not exist. You cannot interact without first reaching. This is not physics; it is logic. The causal sequence *is* the polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$.

The total field coupling hierarchy is:

$$f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 1 + (3{+}1) + (3{+}1)^2 = 1 + 4 + 16 = 21 \tag{16}$$



(a) Face of TetA **(b)** Coupled face: $3 + 1$

FIG. 4. The Field Coupling topology of a single face. **(a)** A triangular face of TetA. **(b)** When TetB couples through the Field Origin, its vertex V_B penetrates the face center, subdividing the face into $3 + 1 = 4$ sub-regions: three corner sub-regions (blue) anchored at the original vertices, and one central coupling sub-region (red) at the penetration point. The $3 + 1$ structure recurs at every scale of the hierarchy.

Why there is no fourth term. A k^3 term would represent a 3-dimensional coupling cell on the boundary of the tetrahedron. But coupling occurs on the *surface* of the simplex, which is 2-dimensional (triangular faces). There is no 3-cell on the boundary of a tetrahedron. Numerically, adding $k^3 = 64$ would give an exponent of 85, and α^{85} is effectively zero: the coupling would contribute nothing observable. The polynomial has exactly three terms because the simplex surface has exactly three types of cells: 0-cells (vertices), 1-cells (edges), and 2-cells (faces).

The gravitational field traverses all 21 coupling levels. Each level attenuates by the fine-structure constant α (Section VI derives α as the topology's own scale ratio), giving the coupling depth α^{21} in the expression for G. The number 21 is derived from the field topology, not imported from elsewhere.

The geometric series identity

The polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ has a revealing algebraic identity:

$$f(k) = \frac{k^3 - 1}{k - 1} = \frac{k^d - 1}{k - 1} = \frac{64 - 1}{3} = 21 \tag{17}$$

This is the standard geometric series with ratio k and $d = 3$ terms. The identity connects the polynomial directly to the dimension of space: $d = 3$ terms in the series because $d = 3$ spatial dimensions. The series sums $(k^d - 1)/(k - 1)$, which for a simplex in d dimensions counts the total number of coupling levels on the boundary. The connection between the polynomial and the dimension is not imposed; it is the definition of a geometric series on a simplex.

Clarification: the "1" versus the "+1"

The hierarchy contains a "1" and the spacetime structure contains a "+1." These are related but distinct.

Symbol	**What it represents**	**Where it applies**
The "+1" in (3+1)	Time as a dimension	Throughout spacetime
The "1" in the hierarchy	Time's origin (EXIST)	At $r = 0$, where $t = r/c = 0$

TABLE III. The distinction between time as dimension (the "+1" in 3+1) and the temporal origin (the "1" in $f(k)$).

B. Why Each Coefficient Is One

The polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ has unit coefficients: each power of k appears exactly once. This is not a choice; it is forced by the structure.

Consider what each coefficient counts:

- $a = 1$ (coefficient of k^0): Existence is binary. The field either encloses volume ($\det(e) \neq 0$) or it does not ($\det(e) = 0$). There is one existence condition, not two. One Field Origin, not two.

- $b = 1$ (coefficient of k^1): Each face couples once. The connection between a field region and its neighbor is a single shared boundary. One connection per neighboring cell.

- $c = 1$ (coefficient of k^2): Each entry of the frame transition matrix counts once. The matrix $\mathcal{S}^a_b$ is a map from one frame to another, not a weighted sum. One matrix entry per pair of frame directions.

Each coefficient counts "how many of this type," and the answer is always one. Unit coefficients are the statement that the geometry is a simplex and the coupling is democratic: no face is privileged, no coupling mode is weighted.

The geometric series identity (Eq. 17) provides the mathematical confirmation. The standard geometric series $\sum_{n=0}^{d-1} k^n = (k^d - 1)/(k - 1)$ has all coefficients equal to 1 by definition. The coupling polynomial is this geometric series with $d = 3$. If any coefficient departed from unity, the polynomial would no longer equal $(k^d - 1)/(k - 1)$, and the connection to simplex geometry would be broken.

This can be tested. Suppose $f(k) = 1 + 2k + k^2 = 25$. Then $f(k) \neq (k^3 - 1)/(k - 1)$, the polynomial no longer represents the dimensional sum on a simplex boundary, the geometric series identity fails, and the three structural states no longer satisfy the arithmetic mean relation (Section IV C). Departing from unity destroys the structural identity. The coefficients are 1 because the geometry is a simplex and the coupling is democratic. There is no freedom to adjust them.

C. The Three Structural States

The 21 coupling levels of Section IV A assume all channels are active. In the actual stellated octahedron, however, the coupling hierarchy is recursive: structure couples through origin to structure. Different structural regions see different channels because the Field Origin is the nonlinear coupling boundary between structures, not a structural region itself.

Of the polynomial's three terms, each maps onto a level of the recursive structure. The Field Origin (1) is the nonlinear coupling boundary where $r = 0$, present in every field configuration. The bimetric interaction ($k^2 = 16$) is a relationship between two structures at that boundary: if TetA couples to TetB, TetB couples to TetA, requiring no preferred

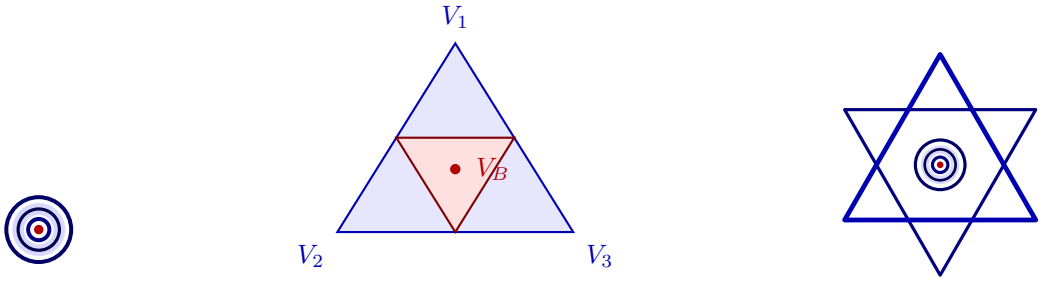
direction. The middle term, $k = 4$, is different in kind: it represents field propagation through the four channels of one coupled face, the linear transport of the field through one sector of the stellated octahedron. Field propagation requires spatial extent ($r > 0$ and direction) and therefore exists only within a structural region, never at the coupling boundary.

The stellated octahedron has three distinct structural regions, and the state coefficient s determines whether face channels contribute:

- In **TetA** $(s = +1)$, the field propagates outward through the four face channels with full coupling. The middle term contributes $+k$.
- At the **Field Origin** $(s = 0)$, the two tetrahedra couple at $r = 0$. This is the nonlinear coupling boundary, not a structural region: no spatial extent exists for face channels to operate. The middle term contributes 0.
- In **TetB** $(s = -1)$, the field propagates through the opposite sector's coupled face. The reversed orientation inverts the face contribution. The middle term contributes $-k$.

Evaluating $f(k) = 1 + s \cdot k + k^2$ in each structural state gives the three integers in G:

Structural state	**Polynomial**	**Value**	**Role in G**
TetA ($s = +1$, apex-up)	$1 + (3{+}1) + (3{+}1)^2$	$= 21$	exponent
Field Origin ($s = 0$)	$1 + \quad 0 \quad + (3{+}1)^2$	$= 17$	numerator
TetB ($s = -1$, apex-down)	$1 - (3{+}1) + (3{+}1)^2$	$= 13$	denominator



(a) EXIST: $k^0 = 1$ **(b) PROPAGATE:** $k^1 = 4$ **(c) INTERACT:** $k^2 = 16$

FIG. 5. The three topological components of $f(k) = 1 + s \cdot k + k^2$: **(a)** the Field Origin (1), **(b)** one coupled face ($k = 4$), and **(c)** the full stellated octahedron ($k^2 = 16$). The structural state s determines which components contribute.

All three integers in G emerge from one polynomial evaluated in the three structural regions of the stellated octahedron.

Why only the middle term changes

The structural argument is direct. Of the three terms, $k^0 = 1$ (a point) has no spatial extent to reverse. $k^2 = 16$ (a relationship) is symmetric: if TetA couples to TetB, then TetB couples to TetA regardless of orientation. But $k^1 = 4$ (propagation) has direction and spatial extent, and reversing the field orientation reverses that direction. Parity confirms this: under $k \to -k$, even powers (k^0, k^2) are unchanged, while the single odd power (k^1) changes sign.

The ghost-free condition fixes two opposite orientations (Section III A), plus one boundary where they couple ($r = 0$), giving exactly three structural states. No fourth configuration exists. One polynomial, three regions, three integers.

The arithmetic mean lock

The three structural states are rigidly constrained by an algebraic identity:

$$\frac{f(+k) + f(-k)}{2} = \frac{21 + 13}{2} = 17 = f(0) \tag{18}$$

The Field Origin value is exactly the arithmetic mean of the TetA and TetB values. This holds for any polynomial of the form $1 + sk + k^2$; it is an algebraic identity, not a numerical coincidence. The three states are equally spaced: $21 - 17 = 17 - 13 = k = 4$. They are as rigidly constrained as three equally spaced marks on a ruler. There is no room to adjust one without breaking all three.

The prefactor: coupling capacity over spatial structure

The three structural states determine where each integer appears in G. The exponent 21 counts the full coupling depth from TetA, where all channels are active. The prefactor is a ratio comparing two structural states:

The numerator, 17, is the polynomial evaluated at the Field Origin ($s = 0$): $17 = k^2 + 1 = (3{+}1)^2 + 1$. At the coupling boundary, face channels are absent, leaving the 16 bimetric Field Coupling channels plus 1 for the non-degenerate coupling vertex itself. The numerator counts the coupling *capacity*.

The denominator, 13, is the polynomial evaluated in TetB ($s = -1$): $13 = kd + 1 = 3(3{+}1) + 1$. Each of the $k = 4$ face channels projects onto $d = 3$ spatial dimensions, giving $kd = 12$ spatial components plus 1 for non-degeneracy. The denominator counts the spatial *structure*.

$$\frac{17}{13} = \frac{k^2 + 1}{kd + 1} = \frac{(3{+}1)^2 + 1}{3(3{+}1) + 1} = \frac{\text{coupling capacity}}{\text{spatial structure}} \tag{19}$$

Neither is adjustable; both follow from $k = (3{+}1)$ and $d = 3$.

D. The Structural Identification

One polynomial, three structural states, the gravitational constant, electron spin, and a unique spatial dimension. Before deriving the equations, one question remains: the polynomial's bimetric interaction term $k^2 = 16$ is the same number as the 16 components of the frame transition matrix $\mathcal{S}$ in Hassan-Rosen gravity. Are these the same 16, or merely the same count?

The coupled face matrix

Each tetrahedron has 4 faces classified by orientation relative to the Field Origin: 3 spatial faces (pointing outward) and 1 time face (pointing inward). At the Field Origin, the coupled face matrix C_{ab} measures the coupling amplitude between face a of TetA and face b of TetB:

- Row index a: TetA's a-th face ($a = 0$ time, $a = 1, 2, 3$ spatial)
- Column index b: TetB's b-th face ($b = 0$ time, $b = 1, 2, 3$ spatial)
- Total: $4 \times 4 = 16$ coupling channels

The Hassan-Rosen frame transition matrix is $\mathcal{S}^a_{\ b} = (E^{-1})^a_{\ \mu}\, L^\mu_{\ b}$, where E^a_μ and L^a_μ are the vierbein fields of the two metrics. Its 16 components measure how each leg of one tetrad projects onto each leg of the other through the coupling point.

Proposition. *Under the conditions that (a) both tetrads share a common coupling point (the Field Origin of the Hassan-Rosen Hamiltonian), (b) the symmetric vielbein condition holds at that point (required for existence of a real square root [7]), and (c) compatible* (3+1) *decompositions exist (required for a well-posed Hamiltonian [29]), the coupled face matrix C_{ab} of the stellated octahedron is identically the Hassan-Rosen frame transition matrix $\mathcal{S}^a_{\ b}$.*

Proof by five identification conditions.

(i) Index identification. Barbieri [27] proved that at each 4-valent node of the gravitational field, the closure constraint $\sum_i \vec{N}_i = 0$ on four face normals uniquely defines a tetrahedron from the spatial triad. Each vierbein leg a therefore labels a face direction: $a = 0$ (timelike) corresponds to the time face, and $a = 1, 2, 3$ (the spatial triad) correspond to the three spatial faces. The Lorentz index on $\mathcal{S}$ and the face index on C label the same structural object. This correspondence is forced by the closure constraint, not chosen by convention.

(ii) Operational identification. The matrix $\mathcal{S}^a_{\ b}$ projects TetB's b-th vierbein leg onto TetA's a-th leg through the coupling point where both metrics are defined. C_{ab} measures the coupling amplitude between TetA's a-th face and TetB's b-th face at the Field Origin where both tetrahedra meet. Once vierbein leg equals face direction by (i), the two operations are identical.

(iii) Block decomposition. The matrix $\mathcal{S}$ decomposes into (3+1) × (3+1) blocks:

$\mathcal{S}^0_0$: 1 component time face ↔ time face

$\mathcal{S}^0_j$: 3 components time face ↔ spatial faces

$\mathcal{S}^i_0$: 3 components spatial faces ↔ time face

$\mathcal{S}^i_j$: 9 components spatial faces ↔ spatial faces

This block structure is the ADM decomposition of the vierbein into lapse/shift (timelike) and spatial triad (spacelike). Hassan and Kocic [29] require compatible (3+1) decompositions for both metrics, which means the block structure of $\mathcal{S}$ is the (3+1) × (3+1) face pairing that the stellated octahedron exhibits.

(iv) Polynomial decomposition. The Hassan-Rosen interaction Hamiltonian is $H_{\text{int}} = m^2\sqrt{g}\,\sum_{n=0}^{4}\beta_n\, e_n(\mathcal{S})$. Each elementary symmetric polynomial $e_n(\mathcal{S})$ contains $\binom{4}{n}$ terms, reflecting the number of ways to select n eigenvalue-directions from 4 vierbein legs. By identification (i), this is identically the number of ways to select n faces from the 4 faces of a tetrahedron. The total number of terms across all five polynomials is $\sum_{n=0}^{4}\binom{4}{n} = 2^4 = 16$. The combinatorics of the elementary symmetric polynomials are the combinatorics of face selection.

(v) Existence condition. The condition $\det(e) \neq 0$ is simultaneously: (a) field closure; (b) the existence condition for $\mathcal{S}$, since forming $\sqrt{g^{-1}f}$ requires g invertible [7]; and (c) the well-posedness of the bimetric ADM Hamiltonian [29]. The constant term "1" in $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ is the Field Origin's contribution to the hierarchy: the non-degenerate coupling point where the two tetrahedra meet. □

Consequences for the three integers

The identification grounds the three integers of G in the Hamiltonian structure of bimetric gravity:

17 = 16 + 1 (Field Origin, $s = 0$). The complete coupled face matrix $\mathcal{S}^a_b$ provides 16 Field Coupling channels. Field closure ($\det(e) \neq 0$) adds one: the precondition for $\mathcal{S}$ to exist. Together, 17 is the coupling capacity at the Field Origin.

13 = 12 + 1 (TetB, $s = -1$). In the inverted sector, the coupling projects onto spatial dimensions: $kd = 12$ directed spatial coupling components plus 1 for spatial non-degeneracy. The equivalence $k^2 - k = k(k-1) = kd$ follows from $k = d + 1$.

21 = 16 + 4 + 1 (TetA, $s = +1$). All channels active: 16 from the bimetric interaction, 4 from propagation through (3+1) face channels, and 1 from existence. The full coupling depth through which gravity propagates.

Two derivations, one matrix. The coupled face matrix from topology and the frame transition matrix from the Hamiltonian are the same 4×4 matrix with the same symmetry constraints. Every integer in G and α traces to a named quantity in published bimetric gravity: 16 = frame transition matrix components (Hassan and Rosen 2012), 17 = Hamiltonian interaction space dimension (Hassan and Kocic 2018), 28 = phase-locking channels (constraint algebra). The framework does not invent mathematics. It applies known results.

The polynomial as weight function

The self-similarity of the coupled face hierarchy is visible in the topology: each coupled face of the stellated octahedron contains within itself the same three levels: one coupling vertex (where TetB's apex penetrates the face), four sub-regions (the (3+1) subdivision created by the penetration), and sixteen cross-modes (each sub-region coupling to each mode of the opposite face), giving $1 + 4 + 16 = 21$ coupling elements on the face, the same hierarchy as the whole structure. The part encodes the whole.

This self-similarity is not an optional topological property. It is a requirement of field closure under finite propagation speed. Field closure ($\det(e) \neq 0$) must hold at every scale. The field propagates at c. At scale R, closure must complete within causal time R/c. The coupled face architecture $1+k+k^2$ achieves closure for one tile of size r_e. For closure at $R > r_e$, the same architecture must operate at scale R, with each level recapitulating the full hierarchy. If the hierarchy did not recurse, there would exist a scale above which the field could not close within the causal constraint of c, and $\det(e)$ would fail. The polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ is therefore the recursion relation of a necessarily self-similar closure structure. The weight k^n at level n is the number of closure channels required at that scale. This is why gravity scales: the same topology operates at every level because field closure demands it.

The identification $\mathcal{S}^a_b = C_{ab}$, the self-similar recursion, and the dual tetrad structure together establish that the coupling polynomial $f(k)$ is not merely a counting device but the weight function of the bimetric interaction, assigning to each structural level its coupling strength. Section VIII A shows that this weight function determines all five parameters of the Hassan-Rosen interaction potential.

With the structural identification established, we can now derive the equations.

V. EQUATIONS FROM THE DUAL TETRAHEDRON TOPOLOGY

This section presents the equations that emerge from the dual tetrahedron topology. We begin at the center: G from tetrad topology, which encodes the (3+1) structure in every term. From this center, three fundamental relationships radiate outward: the inverse square law (connecting Newton and Coulomb), mass-energy equivalence (explaining why c appears squared), and the force hierarchy (resolving the 10^{-43} ratio). These are followed by quantum consistency checks.

A. G from Tetrad Topology

The equation for G encodes the (3+1) structure in every term. Every piece has a structural name; nothing is free. The equation contains a deep insight: the "1" that appears four times is the Field Origin, where $t = 0$.

Where time vanishes and originates

Section III B established that $\tau_{\text{prop}} = r/c = 0$ at the Field Origin, and that the origin is not merely where time vanishes but the source from which time radiates outward. The zero *is* the source.

The equation for G

The gravitational constant, with the (3+1) structure visible in every component:

Result 1: G from Tetrad Topology

$$\boldsymbol{G = \frac{(3+1)^2+1}{3(3+1)+1} \times \alpha^{1+(3+1)+(3+1)^2} \times \frac{\hbar c}{m_e^2}} \tag{20}$$

Predicted: $\mathbf{6.666 \times 10^{-11}}$ m^3/(kg·s^2) Measured: 6.674×10^{-11} m^3/(kg·s^2)

Agreement: 0.12% at tree level; 0.001% at one loop. Not fitted.

The tree-level 0.12% deviation exceeds the CODATA relative uncertainty. Section IX B identifies this residual as the Schwinger one-loop correction $\alpha/(2\pi)$, the same universal QED self-interaction that shifts the electron g-factor; including it reduces the residual to 0.001%.

The exponent is catastrophically sensitive. The exponent $1 + (3{+}1) + (3{+}1)^2 = 21$ is not one of many workable values. Each unit change multiplies the prediction by $1/\alpha \approx 137$:

Exponent	Predicted G	Deviation from measurement
20	9.1×10^{-9}	$\times$137 too large
21	$\mathbf{6.67 \times 10^{-11}}$	**0.12%**
22	4.9×10^{-13}	$\times$137 too small

Adjacent integers miss by over two orders of magnitude. The agreement at 21 is sharply selective. The value $21 = 1 + 4 + 16$ is the only integer in the vicinity that produces a physically reasonable gravitational constant.

Extracting the exponent from measured G gives $n = \log(G\,m_e^2/(\hbar c))/\log(\alpha) = 21.000$ to six significant figures. The integer is exact, and it equals $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 21$. The polynomial writes the exponent.

The entire equation is determined by a single integer, the spatial dimension d:

$$G = \frac{(d+1)^2+1}{d(d+1)+1} \times \alpha^{1+(d+1)+(d+1)^2} \times \frac{\hbar c}{m_e^2} \tag{21}$$

Setting $d = 3$ produces the prefactor 17/13, the exponent 21, and the observed gravitational constant. No other value of d yields a universe with both stable orbits and stable atoms.

The four "1"s

The equation for G contains four distinct appearances of "1," each representing the Field Origin from a different perspective:

Location	**Expression**	**Value**	**Physical meaning**
Exponent start	$\mathbf{1} + 4 + 16$	21	The Field Origin ($t = 0$), source of hierarchy
Spacetime structure	$3 + \mathbf{1}$	4	3 space + 1 time radiating from origin
Numerator	$16 + \mathbf{1}$	17	Bimetric channels + origin as coupling interface
Denominator	$12 + \mathbf{1}$	13	Spatial couplings + origin as structural base

TABLE IV. The four appearances of "1" in the equation for G. Every "1" is the same topological object: the Field Origin.

The three terms of the polynomial map directly onto the three structural levels: the Field Origin (1), one coupled face ($k = 4$), and the bimetric interaction ($k^2 = 16$). The dual tetrad structure is self-consistent: (3+1) appears in the dimensions, in the faces, in the prefactor, and in the exponent. The "1" appears as time, as origin, as coupling interface, and as structural foundation.

How the equation encodes all four results

The equation for G is one topological structure with four readable consequences:

Dimensionality → inverse square law. The $(3+1)$ in the prefactor reflects the four subregions of one coupled face (Figure 4), the minimal simplex structure in $d = 3$ dimensions. The same three-dimensionality produces $1/r^2$ through field spreading.

Bimetric structure → c^2. The scale $\hbar c/m_e^2$ contains c in the numerator. The bimetric structure, requiring two tetrahedra with closure speed c each, explains why mass-energy conversion involves $c \times c = c^2$.

Coupling levels → force hierarchy. The exponent 21 encodes the full hierarchy. Gravity traverses all levels; electromagnetism uses 1. The ratio $\alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}$ follows.

Complete equation $\rightarrow G$. Combining the $(3 + 1)$ prefactor, coupling (α^{21}), and scale $(\hbar c/m_e^2)$ yields G to 0.12% at tree level.

The origin connects everything

The Field Origin is not incidental. It is the reason gravity exists:

- Without the origin: no $t = 0$ point, no source for time
- Without the coupling point: no bimetric interaction
- Without the "1" in the exponent: no hierarchy

The number (3+1) appears in the dimensions, in the faces, in the prefactor, and in the exponent. The "1" appears as time, as origin, as coupling interface, and as structural foundation. This result does not merely calculate G; it encodes the topology of spacetime itself.

The three sections that follow unpack the consequences that radiate from this center.

B. The Inverse Square Law, $E = mc^2$, and the Force Hierarchy

The Inverse Square Law

Newton's gravitational force and Coulomb's electrostatic force share an identical spatial form: both decrease as $1/r^2$. This coincidence has persisted for centuries without topological explanation.

The dual tetrahedron topology provides the answer through dimensional geometry. $1/r^2$ is geometric dilution in $d = 3$: a field emanating from a point source in three dimensions spreads over a spherical surface whose area at distance r is $4\pi r^2$. If field strength is conserved, intensity must decrease as the area increases: intensity $\propto 1/r^2$.

Result 2: The Inverse Square Law

$$\boldsymbol{F \propto \frac{1}{r^2}} \quad \text{(for both gravity and electromagnetism)} \tag{22}$$

Field spreading in three-dimensional space produces $1/r^2$ universally. The tetrahedron's four faces reflect the same $d = 3$.

Both Newton and Coulomb wrote $F \propto 1/r^2$. The spatial form is identical; only the prefactors (G versus k_e) and sources (mass versus charge) differ. Electromagnetism and gravity are topological siblings: both obey $1/r^2$ because both propagate through three-dimensional space, differing only in coupling depth (α^1 versus α^{21}).

Mass-Energy Equivalence

The formula for G contains the scale $\hbar c/m_e^2$. Einstein's equation is $E = mc^2$. Both contain c^2. In dual tetrad gravity, this shared factor is not coincidence: the "squared" in c^2 has the same topological origin as the "squared" in $(3{+}1)^2$. Both reflect the bimetric structure. To see why, consider where mass exists in this field structure.

Mass is energy that does not propagate: a photon (massless) travels at c, while a massive particle at rest remains localized. In dual tetrad gravity, mass is energy bound at the Field Origin, the "1" where the two tetrahedra couple and where $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$. The binding mechanism is topological: energy at the Field Coupling point is shared between the two tetrahedra simultaneously, with each sector's boundary conditions preventing the energy from propagating outward through either one alone. A particle with mass is a stable configuration of energy localized at this coupling point.

The Field Origin maintains field closure: the requirement that the vierbein remain non-degenerate ($\det(e) \neq 0$) across the tile. Closure propagates at the speed of light c. The tile

has characteristic size r (Section II E). The closure rate across the tile is therefore:

$$\omega_{\text{closure}} = \frac{c}{r} \tag{23}$$

This is the total bandwidth of the closure process: how many radians per second the field traverses to maintain consistency across the tile.

The topology does not contain a single interaction mode. It contains N independent interaction states, one for each way the dual tetrahedral structure can couple internally. (The state count N is derived in Section VI from the stellated octahedron's structure; for now, N is a finite integer determined by the topology.) The stellated octahedron treats all states equivalently: no vertex is privileged, no coupling mode is preferred. Closure must therefore service each state in turn, dividing the total bandwidth equally. The per-state closure rate is:

$$\omega_{\text{state}} = \frac{c}{Nr} \tag{24}$$

One cycle at angular frequency ω carries energy $\hbar\omega$. The tile's rest energy is the energy required to complete one closure sub-cycle:

$$mc^2 = \hbar \cdot \frac{c}{Nr} \qquad \Longrightarrow \qquad m = \frac{\hbar}{Nrc} \tag{25}$$

This is the mass of the tile. It is the energy cost of maintaining field closure across N interaction states at speed c. A tile with a larger radius r requires less energy per sub-cycle (lower frequency, lower mass). A topology with more interaction states N divides the closure bandwidth into finer slices (lower per-state rate, lower mass for fixed r). The formula $m = \hbar/(Nrc)$ contains no adjustable parameters: c is the closure speed, r is the tile size, N is the state count, and $\hbar$ converts frequency to energy.

The physical interpretation is direct. The electron's Compton angular frequency $\omega_{\text{Compton}} = mc^2/\hbar$ equals the per-state closure rate $c/(Nr)$. When Section VI derives $N = 1/\alpha$, this formula becomes $m = \alpha\hbar/(rc)$, the classical electron radius relation. That relation is not an external input imported from electromagnetism; it is a consequence of mass being closure energy.

Now consider what happens during mass-energy conversion. The preceding equations describe how much energy mass contains. The next question is: in what form does that energy

emerge? Energy stored at the Field Origin must propagate outward through the bimetric structure. The topology is $(3{+}1)^2$, not (3+1): two spacetimes, not one. Each tetrahedron maintains field consistency at its closure speed:

$$c_{\text{TetA}} = c_{\text{TetB}} = c \tag{26}$$

Energy released from the Field Origin engages both sectors:

Result 3: Mass-Energy Equivalence

$$\boldsymbol{E = m \times c_{\text{TetA}} \times c_{\text{TetB}} = m \times c \times c = mc^2} \tag{27}$$

The c^2 factor is the product of two closure speeds, one from each tetrahedron.

The hierarchy thus answers four questions simultaneously:

1. **What is mass?** The energy cost of maintaining field closure across N interaction states (Eq. 25)
2. **Where is mass?** At the "1" (the Field Origin, where $\tau_{\text{prop}} = 0$)
3. **Why does conversion involve c?** Because each tetrahedron has closure speed c
4. **Why c^2?** Because $(3+1)^2$ means two tetrahedra, hence $c \times c$

Einstein's equation is not separate from the coupling hierarchy. It is a direct reading of the dual tetrad field structure: mass as closure energy at the Field Origin, conversion through two spacetimes, c^2 from two closure speeds.

The Force Hierarchy

Newton's gravity and Coulomb's electromagnetism share $1/r^2$. Yet gravity is approximately 10^{43} times weaker. If the geometry is identical, why do the strengths differ? The hierarchy

problem is a counting problem.

The coupling polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ has three terms. Different forces engage different levels: electromagnetism involves charge within a single (3+1) sector, engaging only the first term (coupling depth 1, strength $\propto \alpha^1$). Gravity involves mass at the Field Origin where both tetrahedra meet, engaging the complete coupled face (coupling depth 21, strength $\propto \alpha^{21}$).

Result 4: The Force Hierarchy

$$\frac{\text{Gravity}}{\text{EM}} \sim \frac{\boldsymbol{\alpha^{1+k+k^2}}}{\boldsymbol{\alpha^1}} = \boldsymbol{\alpha^{k+k^2} = \alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}} \tag{28}$$

Both forces share the Field Origin (α^1). Gravity also traverses the coupled face (α^k) and bimetric interaction (α^{k^2}), accumulating $k + k^2 = 20$ additional levels.

The hierarchy dissolves. Gravity is not mysteriously weak. It is naturally attenuated because it must traverse the complete coupled face: all three levels of the polynomial versus electromagnetism's single level. The 20-level gap decomposes cleanly: $k = 4$ from the face structure, $k^2 = 16$ from the bimetric interaction.

C. Quantum Consistency

The dual tetrad structure operates at the scale of the electron radius, deep within the quantum regime. A topology that determines G at this scale must be consistent with quantum behavior. This subsection examines three aspects of quantum physics through the topological lens.

Energy Quantization

Quantization is resonance. The Field Origin acts as a topological boundary condition at $r = 0$. Consider a guitar string: fixed endpoints permit only standing waves with specific wavelengths. Similarly, the Field Origin's structure selects which field configurations can stably exist.

Interpretation: Energy Quantization

$$E = hf \tag{29}$$

The Field Origin selects discrete resonance modes. Energy is quantized because only standing waves that fit the origin boundary can persist. h is an empirical input, not derived here.

Planck's constant $h = 6.626 \times 10^{-34}$ J·s is small because the Field Origin is at the smallest scale. It represents the "grain size" of resonance: the minimum action required for one complete cycle at the coupling point.

Wave-Particle Duality

Light sometimes behaves as a wave (interference) and sometimes as a particle (photoelectric effect). De Broglie proposed that every particle has an associated wavelength $\lambda = h/p$. In the dual tetrad framework, this follows from structure: a "particle" is a resonance at a Field Origin; a "wave" is how that resonance propagates through (3+1) space. Detection (particle behavior) occurs at the Field Origin. Propagation (wave behavior) occurs through the surrounding spacetime. The duality reflects the topology: localized origin, extended field.

Consistency Check: Wave-Particle Duality

$$\lambda = \frac{h}{p} \tag{30}$$

De Broglie's relation follows algebraically from $E = hf$ combined with the relativistic energy-momentum relation. The topology contributes through the boundary conditions that produce quantization.

The Energy-Momentum Relation

$E = mc^2$ applies to objects at rest. The complete relationship for moving objects is Einstein's energy-momentum relation, which has the structure of the Pythagorean theorem in energy-momentum space:

Consistency Check: The Energy-Momentum Relation

$$E^2 = (pc)^2 + (m_0c^2)^2 \tag{31}$$

The Pythagorean form follows from the invariance of the (3+1) spacetime interval. For a particle at rest ($p = 0$): $E = m_0c^2$. For a massless particle ($m_0 = 0$): $E = pc$. Both limiting cases are standard special relativity.

The framework does not quantize gravity by fiat. It shows that the topological structure already contains discrete modes. The question "how do you quantize gravity?" becomes "why would you expect a resonant topology to produce continuous spectra?"

VI. THE FINE-STRUCTURE CONSTANT

Section V derived G by reading the dual tetrahedron topology in depth: α^{21} coupling levels from the Field Origin through the full bimetric interaction. This section reads the same topology in breadth: how many interaction states does the structure contain? The answer is $1/\alpha = 137.036$, the most precisely measured constant in physics.

A. Alpha as a Topological Ratio

The fine-structure constant α is a ratio of two scales, both arising from the same topology. The numerator is the field scale (where the topology lives); the denominator is the quantum scale (where coherence sets the wavelength).

Section II E established that two independent routes, one electromagnetic and one gravitational, converge on the same characteristic length: the classical electron radius $r_e = 2.818 \times 10^{-15}$ m. The quantum mechanical scale associated with the electron is the reduced Compton wavelength $\bar{\lambda}_C = \hbar/(m_e c) = 3.862 \times 10^{-13}$ m. The ratio of these two scales is:

$$\alpha = \frac{r_e}{\bar{\lambda}_C} = \frac{r_e}{\hbar/(m_e c)} = \frac{e^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0\,\hbar c} \tag{32}$$

This is the textbook definition of the fine-structure constant. But in the dual tetrad framework, it has a topological interpretation: α is the lattice spacing divided by the quantum coherence length. Just as the speed of sound in a crystal is determined by the ratio of atomic spacing to the thermal wavelength, the coupling strength α is determined by the ratio of the field scale r_e to the quantum scale $\bar{\lambda}_C$.

The key insight: both forces (electromagnetism and gravity) share the same α. Both arise from the same stellated octahedron. Both use the same r_e as characteristic scale. Therefore both are governed by the same coupling ratio. α is not a property specific to photons; it is the coupling language of three-dimensional space.

α read two ways gives two constants. Read the topology in *depth* (how many coupling levels) and you get G through α^{21}. Read the topology in *breadth* (how many interaction states) and you get α itself through $1/\alpha = 137.036$. Two readings of one structure.

B. The Integer 137: Breadth of the Hierarchy

If G reads the topology's depth (21 coupling levels), then $1/\alpha$ reads its breadth: the total number of Hamiltonian interaction states.

Consider a tree. Its depth is how far one root reaches into the ground: that is the exponent 21. Its breadth is the canopy, how many leaves catch sunlight: that is $1/\alpha$. Both measurements describe the same tree; they just read different directions.

The stellated octahedron has $k^2 + 1 = 17$ interaction modes at the Field Origin (Section IV C). Each of the 8 vertices of the stellated octahedron (Section III D) contributes these modes, but the two tetrahedra share the Field Origin, so the total count is:

$$\left.\frac{1}{\alpha}\right|_{\text{integer}} = 1 + 2k(k^2 + 1) = 1 + 8 \times 17 = 137 \tag{33}$$

Every sub-number has a published name:

- The **1** is the bimetric interaction vertex (Hinterbichler and Rosen 2012 [28]): the unique point where the two spin-2 fields couple.
- The **8** is the vierbein leg count from two tetrahedra: $2 \times 4 = 8$ (Barbieri 1998 [27]).
- The **17** is the Hamiltonian interaction space dimension: the $4 \times 4 = 16$ frame transition matrix components plus 1 existence condition (Hassan and Kocic 2018 [29]).

None of these names were invented for this paper. They are standard results in bimetric gravity theory.

The structure encodes itself

The algebraic content of Eq. (33) contains a self-referencing property. Expanding $1+2k(k^2+1)$ gives $2k^3 + 2k + 1$. Setting this equal to 137:

$$2k^3 + 2k + 1 = 137 \quad \Longrightarrow \quad k^3 + k = 68 \tag{34}$$

This cubic equation has a unique positive integer solution: $k = 4$. If you know only that the integer part of $1/\alpha$ is 137, you can recover the tetrahedron by pure algebra. The constant carries the topology in its digits.

137 is breadth, 21 is depth. Breadth counts the total number of interaction states across the stellated octahedron (how many ways two fields can couple). Depth counts the number of coupling levels the field attenuates through (how deep the signal penetrates). Two independent readings of one structure, connected by α:

Reading	**Formula**	**Determines**
Depth (down into the root)	$f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 21$	G via α^{21}
Breadth (across the canopy)	$1 + 2k(k^2 + 1) = 137$	$1/\alpha$ (integer part)

C. The Fraction 1/28

The integer 137 counts distributed Hamiltonian interaction states. The fraction 1/28 counts a different quantity: the single-cycle contribution from one complete traversal of the vortex structure.

Section III D established that the stellated octahedron has 28 geometric elements and that three independent countings converge on this number: $V + E + F = k(k + d) = 28$. The face-channel count is:

$$k(k + d) = 4 \times (4 + 3) = 4 \times 7 = 28 \tag{35}$$

where $k + d = 7$ counts the effective coupled face modes: $(d + 1) + d = 4 + 3 = 7$. One complete vortex cycle through the stellated octahedron visits all 28 face-channels. Each cycle contributes 1/28 to the inverse fine-structure constant.

The integer and fraction are categorically different quantities; they *add* because they describe different aspects of the same structure:

$$\frac{1}{\alpha} = 137 + \frac{1}{28} = 1 + 2k(k^2 + 1) + \frac{1}{k(k + d)} = 137.0357\ldots \tag{36}$$

Result 5: The Fine-Structure Constant

$$\frac{1}{\alpha} = 1 + 2k(k^2+1) + \frac{1}{k(k+d)} = 137.0357\ldots \tag{37}$$

Predicted: $1/\alpha = 137.0357$ Measured: $1/\alpha = 137.0360$ [18]

Agreement: 0.00021%. Not fitted.

137 counts rooms and 1/28 is the hallway connecting them. They are different kinds of quantities, so they combine additively, like "137 rooms plus 1/28 of a corridor." The integer measures breadth (how many Hamiltonian interaction states the topology can hold). The fraction measures a single vortex-cycle contribution (what one traversal through the 28 face-channels contributes). They add because counting states and counting cycle-fractions are complementary measurements of the same coupled structure.

D. Confirmation from Physical Rates

The derivations of α in Sections VI B and VI C proceed by counting vertices, faces, and states. An independent confirmation uses none of these: it derives α from physical rates alone.

The field closure frequency is the rate at which the field maintains consistency across the characteristic scale r_e:

$$f_{\text{closure}} = \frac{c}{r_e} \tag{38}$$

The Compton frequency is the quantum clock rate of the electron:

$$f_{\text{Compton}} = \frac{m_e c^2}{h} \tag{39}$$

The ratio of these two frequencies is:

$$\frac{f_{\text{closure}}}{f_{\text{Compton}}} = \frac{c/r_e}{m_e c^2/h} = \frac{h}{m_e c\, r_e} = \frac{\hbar/(m_e c)}{r_e} \times 2\pi = \frac{\bar{\lambda}_C}{r_e} \times 2\pi = \frac{2\pi}{\alpha} \tag{40}$$

This route uses only c, r_e, m_e, and h, quantities that enter the framework through different pathways than the state-counting derivation. Two completely different methods, from two different conceptual domains, converge on the same α to 0.00021%. When two derivations share an answer but not a method, the underlying structure is consistent.

E. What This Means

The fine-structure constant has puzzled physicists since Sommerfeld introduced it in 1916. Feynman called it "one of the greatest damn mysteries of physics" [21]. Pauli reportedly said that when he died, his first question to the Devil would be: why 137?

The answer is topological. The integer 137 counts Hamiltonian interaction states of the stellated octahedron, with every sub-number traceable to a named quantity in published bimetric gravity. The fractional part 1/28 counts the single-cycle contribution from the stellated octahedron's 28 geometric elements. An independent rate-ratio confirmation (Section VI D) agrees to 0.00021%.

The fine-structure constant is not a free parameter alongside G; both are determined by the same dual tetrad topology. Read the coupling hierarchy in depth and you get G through α^{21}. Read it in breadth and you get α through $1/\alpha = 137 + 1/28$. Two readings of one structure. With α derived, the topology's reach extends further: Section VII applies the same structure to galactic dynamics and the Hubble constant, and Section IX demonstrates that the electron mass itself can be derived.

VII. DARK MATTER AND THE HUBBLE CONSTANT

The preceding sections derived the topology's fundamental equations and the fine-structure constant. This section applies the same dual tetrahedron structure to two observational domains: galactic dynamics and the Hubble expansion rate. The characteristic acceleration a_0 that emerges from the coupling channels resolves the dark matter problem at galactic scales, and the cosmological horizon relation then determines the Hubble constant with zero adjustable parameters.

A. Resolution of the Dark Matter Problem

Why does standard cosmology require 85% of gravitational mass to be invisible? The answer lies in a hidden assumption: that spacetime is a structureless continuum through which gravity propagates uniformly at all scales. This assumption, while adequate for solar-system dynamics, fails at galactic scales.

The hidden assumption

Consider calculating ocean tides while assuming water is a structureless continuum. Such a calculation would fail because water has molecular structure: H_2O molecules arrange in tetrahedral electron geometry, and this structure creates bulk properties (viscosity, surface tension, specific heat) that govern large-scale behavior. Ignoring molecular structure while trying to predict tides would require inventing "dark forces" to explain the discrepancy.

The same error occurs in gravitational physics. Standard cosmology treats spacetime as structureless, but fields couple, and coupling creates topology. Just as water molecules form tetrahedral arrangements, the gravitational field couples through the dual tetrahedron structure. This structure creates a characteristic acceleration scale a_0 below which the coupling changes character.

The characteristic scale

The dual tetrahedron topology yields a characteristic acceleration:

$$a_0 = \frac{k^2\, G\, m_e}{r_e^2} = \frac{16\, G\, m_e}{r_e^2} \approx 1.22 \times 10^{-10}\ \mathrm{m/s^2} \tag{41}$$

where $k^2 = 16$ counts the coupling channels through the tetrahedral topology. This derived value matches the empirically observed MOND acceleration scale [17] to 0.41%. The scale a_0 marks a physical boundary: above it, all 16 coupling channels engage and gravity behaves as Newton described. Below it, the field cannot sustain full coupling.

The constitutive law from detailed balance

At each point in the gravitational field, the available coupling capacity divides into two states: a *resolved* fraction ε that tracks the Newtonian demand, and an *unresolved* fraction $(1-\varepsilon)$ where the coupling has saturated. The equilibrium between these two states follows from detailed balance:

- **Resolution rate:** $W_+ = \kappa \cdot x \cdot (1-\varepsilon)$. The field is driven toward resolution by the gravitational intensity $x = g/a_0$.
- **Relaxation rate:** $W_- = \kappa \cdot \varepsilon$. Resolved capacity relaxes back at a rate proportional to ε.

At equilibrium, $W_+ = W_-$:

$$\kappa \cdot x \cdot (1-\varepsilon) = \kappa \cdot \varepsilon \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \varepsilon = \frac{x}{1+x} \tag{42}$$

Since the resolved fraction *is* the fraction of Newtonian gravity that the field transmits, $\mu(x) \equiv \varepsilon(x)$:

$$\mu(x) = \frac{x}{1+x} \quad \text{where} \quad x = \frac{g}{a_0} \tag{43}$$

The driving exponent $n = 1$ is forced by the deep-MOND limit observed in galaxy rotation curves: $\mu/x \to 1$ as $x \to 0$. Any other exponent violates this limit. The "1" in the denominator represents the always-present baseline coupling channel, the Field Origin in the hierarchy $1 + 4 + 16 = 21$. Even when all other channels saturate, this single channel persists.

Milgrom derived $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ empirically from 150+ galaxy rotation curves [17]. The dual tetrahedron topology derives the same function from field closure, without seeing a single galaxy. When a constitutive law derived from face-counting matches one derived from galactic dynamics, the counting is correct.

Three observable consequences

First: gravity transitions from $1/r^2$ to $1/r$. At high accelerations ($g \gg a_0$), $\mu \to 1$ and gravity follows Newton. At low accelerations ($g \ll a_0$), $\mu \to x$ and the effective gravity

becomes:

$$g_{\text{eff}} = \sqrt{g_{\text{Newton}} \times a_0} = \frac{\sqrt{GMa_0}}{r} \propto \frac{1}{r} \tag{44}$$

Second: rotation curves are flat. For circular orbits, $v^2/r = g_{\text{eff}}$. In the deep-MOND regime:

$$v^2 = g_{\text{eff}} \times r = \sqrt{GMa_0} = \text{constant} \tag{45}$$

The rotation velocity is independent of radius: the curve is flat. This is precisely what astronomers observe in every spiral galaxy.

Third: the 85% "dark matter" is explained. At any radius, an observer using Newtonian gravity would infer more mass than is visible:

$$f_{\text{dark}} = 1 - \mu(x) = \frac{1}{1+x} = \frac{a_0}{g + a_0} \tag{46}$$

At typical galaxy outskirts where $g \approx 0.1\, a_0$, this gives $f_{\text{dark}} \approx 90\%$. Integrated over a galaxy, the average is approximately 85%, matching observations. The entire "dark matter" fraction is a calculation artifact from using the wrong distance dependence.

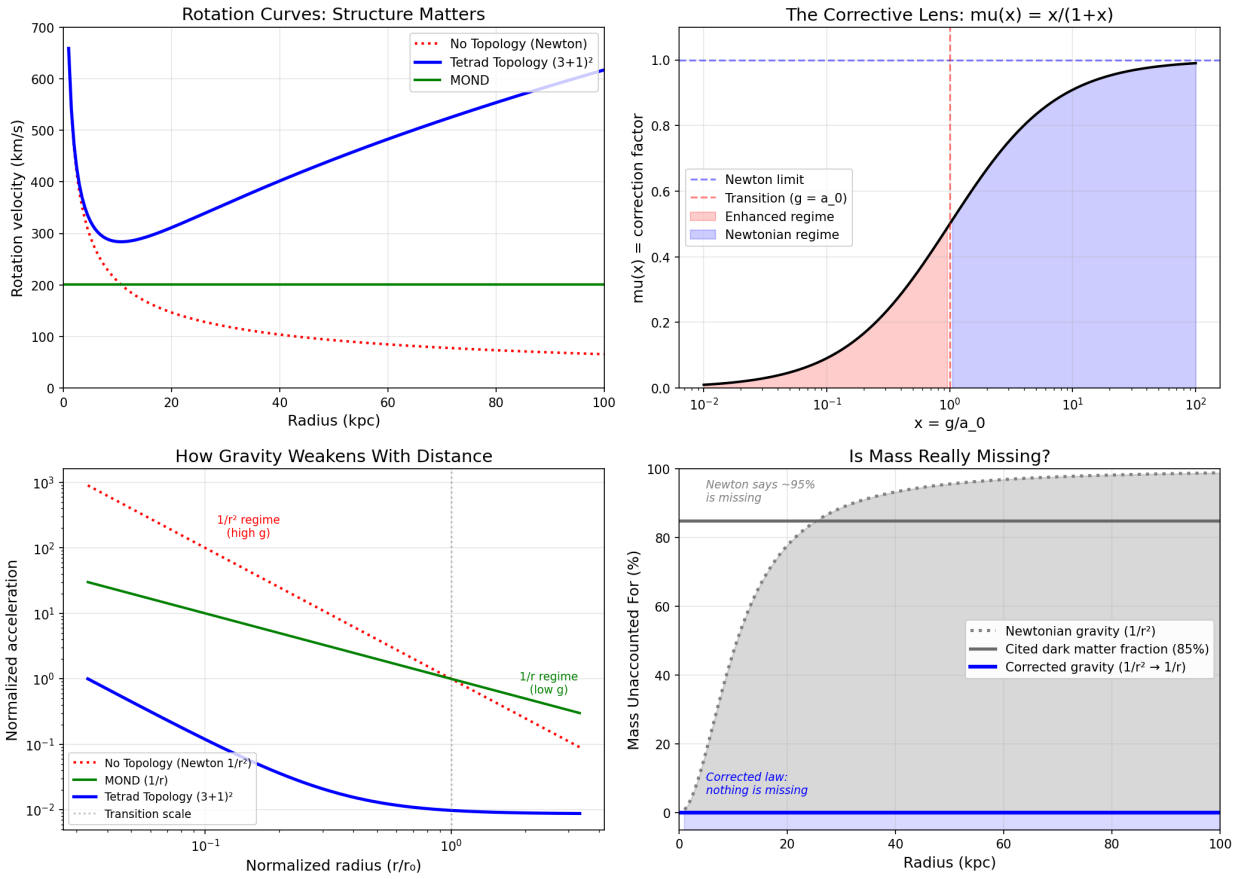


FIG. 6. The dark matter problem as a structural correction for a $10^{11} M_\odot$ galaxy. **Top left:** Rotation curves (Newton declining in red, topology in blue). **Top right:** The correction factor $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$. **Bottom left:** The $1/r^2$ to $1/r$ transition. **Bottom right:** The "missing mass" is entirely explained by the structural correction.

r (kpc)	g/a_0	$\mu(x)$	v_{Newton} (km/s)	v_{actual} (km/s)	"DM" %
5	4.71	0.83	295	324	18%
10	1.18	0.54	208	283	46%
20	0.30	0.23	147	309	77%
30	0.13	0.12	120	354	88%
50	0.05	0.05	93	439	95%

TABLE V. Rotation curve predictions for a $10^{11} M_\odot$ galaxy. As radius increases, the structural correction grows larger. At 30 kpc, dual tetrad gravity predicts 88% apparent dark matter, matching observations without invoking invisible mass.

The corrective lens

Standard calculations assume $M_{\text{inferred}} = v^2 r/G$. Using the correction factor (43), the correct relationship is:

$$M_{\text{actual}} = M_{\text{inferred}} \times \mu(g/a_0) = M_{\text{inferred}} \times \frac{g}{g + a_0} \tag{47}$$

This is the corrective lens that transforms standard cosmological calculations. Applying it removes the need for dark matter: the "missing" 85% is restored as the correction factor, not as additional mass.

The resolution of galaxy-scale dark matter is conceptually identical to correcting tidal calculations by accounting for water's molecular structure. The dark matter problem is resolved not by finding invisible particles, but by recognizing that gravity couples through cellular topology with a characteristic scale $a_0 = k^2 G m_e / r_e^2$. The same topology that determines the electron mass at the smallest scale produces the correct rotation curves at galactic scales, operating bidirectionally across more than 30 orders of magnitude.

Known challenges and how dual tetrad gravity addresses them. The correction factor $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ is the "simple" MOND interpolating function identified empirically by Milgrom [17]. Dual tetrad gravity does not fit this function to data; it derives it as the unique constitutive law satisfying detailed balance at the closure boundary. It is therefore important to address the observational challenges that MOND-type modifications face.

Galaxy clusters present the most significant challenge: even with the MOND correction, clusters appear to require additional mass beyond what baryons provide. The Bullet Cluster, where gravitational lensing centers are offset from the visible gas, is often cited as direct evidence for particle dark matter. Additionally, the CMB power spectrum and large-scale structure formation are well-described by ΛCDM with particle dark matter.

Dual tetrad gravity differs from phenomenological MOND in two respects that bear on these challenges. First, the acceleration scale a_0 is not a free parameter; it is derived from the topology and linked to the Hubble constant through $a_0 = cH/(2\pi) \cdot \sqrt{k/\pi}$. This means a_0 evolves with cosmic time as H evolves, potentially altering the dynamics at cluster scales and high redshift. At recombination ($z \simeq 1100$), a_0 was substantially larger than today, modifying the early-universe enhancement factor. Second, the derivation from detailed balance provides a physical mechanism absent in the empirical MOND prescription.

Whether the full covariant completion (Section VIII A) resolves the remaining cluster-scale and CMB challenges is a testable question; the internal consistency across more than 30 orders of magnitude suggests the extension is feasible.

B. The Hubble Constant

The topology determines the Hubble constant with zero adjustable parameters. The characteristic acceleration a_0 connects to the Hubble expansion rate through the cosmological horizon, completing a derivation chain from $d = 3$ to H.

The observable universe has a cosmological horizon at radius $R_H = c/H$, beyond which light cannot reach us. This horizon defines a minimum resolvable acceleration $a_{\min} \sim c^2/R_H = cH$: any acceleration smaller than this is indistinguishable from the horizon's own curvature. The factor 2π enters as in the Unruh relation, converting between geometric acceleration and the physical threshold:

$$a_0 = \frac{cH}{2\pi}\sqrt{\frac{k}{\pi}} \tag{48}$$

The geometric correction $\sqrt{k/\pi} = \sqrt{4/\pi} \approx 1.128$ accounts for the difference between tetrahedral packing (the discrete field structure) and spherical symmetry (the continuous cosmological horizon). Inverting for H:

Result 6: The Hubble Constant from Topology

$$\boldsymbol{H = \frac{2\pi a_0}{c\sqrt{k/\pi}} = \frac{78.90}{1.128} = 69.92}\ \text{km/s/Mpc} \tag{49}$$

Planck (2020): $\mathbf{67.4 \pm 0.5}$ SH0ES (2022): $\mathbf{73.04 \pm 1.04}$ GW170817: $\mathbf{70.0^{+12.0}_{-8.0}}$

Predicted value falls within the observational range. Zero free parameters.

The predicted $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc falls between the Planck CMB measurement [23] (67.4 ± 0.5) and the SH0ES distance-ladder measurement [24] (73.04 ± 1.04), consistent with the gravitational-wave standard siren from GW170817 [8] ($70.0^{+12.0}_{-8.0}$).

The Hubble tension. The discrepancy between Planck and SH0ES, now exceeding 5σ, is the Hubble tension. Both measurements assume gravity behaves identically at all scales. In dual tetrad gravity, gravity is modified below a_0, affecting both calibrations. The Planck analysis infers H through ΛCDM, which does not account for enhanced gravitational coupling below a_0. The SH0ES analysis calibrates distances using Newtonian gravity, which overestimates luminosity distances at low accelerations. The prediction $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc is not a compromise; it is the value the topology requires. The Hubble tension may reflect the assumption that gravity is scale-invariant, an assumption this framework removes.

H connects back to m_e. The Hubble constant and the electron mass are linked through the closure system. The same two-equation system that gives m_e also gives H. They are not independent measurements of independent quantities; they are two outputs of one topology. Changing one necessarily changes the other.

VIII. COVARIANT COMPLETION

The results derived above follow from the static topology of the stellated octahedron. The structural identification of Section IV D proved that the coupled face matrix and the frame transition matrix are the same object. That identification, together with the structural

states and the coupling polynomial, determines all five parameters of the Hassan-Rosen bimetric interaction, reducing the theory from 5 free parameters to 0.

A. Determining the Five β_n

The established Hassan-Rosen bimetric action [6], written in vielbein form, is:

$$S_{\rm HR} = \int d^4x \left[e\, e_I^\alpha e_J^\beta \Omega_{\alpha\beta}^{IJ}(e) \;+\; \tilde{e}\, \tilde{e}_I^\alpha \tilde{e}_J^\beta \tilde{\Omega}_{\alpha\beta}^{IJ}(\tilde{e}) \;+\; m^2 e \sum_{n=0}^{4} \beta_n\, e_n(e^{-1}\tilde{e}) \right] \tag{50}$$

The first two terms are independent curvatures; the third is their interaction through the elementary symmetric polynomials e_n of the frame transition matrix $\mathcal{S} = e^{-1}\tilde{e}$, weighted by five parameters β_n. By the identification of Section IV D, the 16 components of $\mathcal{S}$ are the 16 coupled face channels of the stellated octahedron, and the $\binom{4}{n}$ terms in each e_n count the ways to select n faces from the 4 faces of a tetrahedron. The five parameters β_n assign a coupling weight to each face-selection order: β_0 weights the term that selects 0 faces, β_1 the term that selects 1 face, and so on through β_4. In the standard theory, these five parameters are free. The structural identification constrains all of them.

Step 1: Parity structure. The elementary symmetric polynomial e_n of a 4×4 matrix with eigenvalues $(\lambda_0, \lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3)$ is a sum over n-element subsets of those eigenvalues. Under full sign reversal $\lambda_i \to -\lambda_i$, the polynomial transforms as $e_n(-\lambda) = (-1)^n\, e_n(\lambda)$: even-order polynomials (e_0, e_2, e_4) are invariant, and odd-order polynomials (e_1, e_3) change sign. This parity maps onto the structural states. In the polynomial $f(k) = 1 + sk + k^2$, the even terms ($k^0 = 1$ and $k^2 = 16$) are unchanged by $s \to -s$, while the odd term ($k^1 = 4$) reverses sign. Even structural levels are orientation-independent; odd structural levels distinguish TetA from TetB. This parity structure motivates the constraints that follow.

Step 2: Metric exchange symmetry (5 → 3 parameters). The stellated octahedron is symmetric under exchanging TetA and TetB: the two tetrahedra have identical geometry with opposite orientations, so no physical distinction selects one over the other. Under $g \leftrightarrow f$, the frame transition matrix transforms as $\mathcal{S} \to \mathcal{S}^{-1}$, and the elementary symmetric polynomials satisfy

$$e_n(\mathcal{S}^{-1}) = \frac{e_{4-n}(\mathcal{S})}{e_4(\mathcal{S})} \tag{51}$$

At the Field Origin, where both tetrad frames coincide at their shared center, the symmetric vielbein condition holds and $g = f$. Hassan and Kocic [29] proved that reality plus general covariance selects a unique square root: $\mathcal{S} = \sqrt{g^{-1}f} = \sqrt{I} = I$. Therefore $e_4(I) = \det(I) = 1$, and $e_n(\mathcal{S}^{-1}) = e_{4-n}(\mathcal{S})$. Invariance of the potential $V = \sum \beta_n e_n$ under $e_n \to e_{4-n}$ requires:

$$\beta_0 = \beta_4, \qquad \beta_1 = \beta_3, \qquad \beta_2 \text{ unconstrained} \tag{52}$$

Selecting 0 faces is the complement of selecting all 4, and the two tetrahedra are interchangeable, so the coupling weights of these complementary selections must be equal. Five free parameters reduce to three: β_0, β_1, β_2.

Step 3: Odd-parity vanishing at the Field Origin (3 → 1 ratio). At the Field Origin (structural state $s = 0$), the structure is symmetric between TetA and TetB. This is the coupling boundary where propagation time vanishes: neither tetrahedron has priority. The interaction potential must be a symmetry extremum with respect to perturbations that break this TetA–TetB equivalence. Odd-order perturbations, which select an odd number of faces and thereby distinguish one tetrahedron from the other, must contribute zero at this symmetric point.

From Step 2, $\beta_1 = \beta_3$. At $\mathcal{S} = I$, the elementary symmetric polynomials evaluate to $e_n(I) = \binom{4}{n}$:

$$e_0(I) = 1, \quad e_1(I) = 4, \quad e_2(I) = 6, \quad e_3(I) = 4, \quad e_4(I) = 1 \tag{53}$$

The odd-parity contribution to the potential at this point is $\beta_1 e_1(I) + \beta_3 e_3(I) = \beta_1 \times 4 + \beta_1 \times 4 = 8\beta_1$. Vanishing at the symmetric extremum requires $8\beta_1 = 0$, so $\beta_1 = 0$ and consequently $\beta_3 = 0$.

Face-selection orders 1 and 3 carry directional information that distinguishes TetA from TetB. At the Field Origin, where no such distinction exists, these configurations are forbidden. Only even selections (0, 2, or 4 faces) survive. Three independent parameters reduce to one free ratio: $\beta_0 : \beta_2$.

Step 4: The coupling polynomial determines the last ratio (1 → 0 free parameters). The surviving interaction potential has three even-parity terms:

$$V(\mathcal{S}) = \beta_0 e_0(\mathcal{S}) + \beta_2 e_2(\mathcal{S}) + \beta_0 e_4(\mathcal{S}) \tag{54}$$

These three terms correspond to the three structural levels of the coupled face hierarchy, the same three levels that appear in the polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$:

- Level 0: The Field Origin itself (weight 1). The two tetrahedra interact by existing at the same point. No faces need to be selected. This is the e_0 term (0 faces) and the e_4 term (all 4 faces, which by metric exchange is the complement of 0). Polynomial weight: $k^0 = 1$.

- Level 1: Face propagation (weight $k = 4$). The (3+1) propagation channels through one face. This level is present in TetA ($s = +1$) and TetB ($s = -1$) but absent at the Field Origin ($s = 0$). It does not appear as a standalone β term because $\beta_1 = \beta_3 = 0$; the 4 channels per face contribute instead as the internal subdivision that every face inherits.

- Level 2: The full bimetric interaction (weight $k^2 = 16$). All 4 faces of TetA coupling to all 4 faces of TetB. The algebraic carrier is e_2, which provides $\binom{4}{2} = 6$ independent pairwise face combinations; the coefficient $\beta_2 = k^2 = 16$ assigns to each combination the channel count of the full interaction. The total weighted contribution is $16 \times 6 = 96$, the dominant term in the potential.

The mapping between even-order elementary symmetric polynomials and coupling levels is uniquely determined by what each face-selection order physically represents: order 0 (no selection) and its complement order 4 correspond to bare existence, not interaction, hence the Field Origin level; order 2 (pairwise selection) is the algebraic carrier of inter-tetrad coupling, hence the bimetric level. There is no alternative assignment consistent with these physical meanings. The self-similarity established in Section IV D makes the weight assignment k^n at each level rigorous: field closure ($\det(e) \neq 0$) must hold at every scale, and the weight k^n is the minimum number of closure channels required at that scale. Each channel couples with equal amplitude because the symmetric geometry provides no mechanism to prefer one channel over another. The ratio is therefore

$$\beta_0 : \beta_2 : \beta_4 = 1 : k^2 : 1 = 1 : 16 : 1 \tag{55}$$

Result. All five β_n are determined:

Parameter	Value	Determining condition
β_0	1	Field Origin level in $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$
β_1	0	Odd parity vanishes at symmetric Field Origin
β_2	16	Full bimetric level in $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$
β_3	0	Odd parity vanishes ($= \beta_1$)
β_4	1	Metric exchange symmetry ($= \beta_0$)

The Hassan-Rosen interaction potential, fully determined by the coupled face geometry, is:

$$V(\mathcal{S}) = e_0(\mathcal{S}) + 16\, e_2(\mathcal{S}) + e_4(\mathcal{S}) \tag{56}$$

Zero free parameters remain. The five coupling constants of bimetric gravity are consequences of the stellated octahedron topology.

Verification. The total weighted channel count is $\beta_0\binom{4}{0} + \beta_2\binom{4}{2} + \beta_4\binom{4}{4} = 1(1) + 16(6) + 1(1) = 98$, dominated by the pairwise interaction term. The potential $V(\mathcal{S})$ evaluates identically in all three structural states: since $\beta_1 = \beta_3 = 0$, only even-parity terms survive, and even-parity terms are invariant under the orientation reversal that distinguishes TetA from TetB. The interaction potential provides the coupling capacity; the structural states determine how that capacity is distributed through space. This is consistent with the dual tetrad topology: 17 and 13 differ because of propagation channels (the odd-parity k term), not because of interaction strength.

Independent testability. This determination is independently testable. The β_n parameters enter the mass spectrum of the bimetric theory: they determine the mass of the massive graviton and the mixing between the two spin-2 fields. Gravitational wave observations from LIGO, Virgo, and KAGRA constrain this mass spectrum through dispersion measurements [8]. Cosmological surveys constrain the parameters through their effect on structure formation and the expansion history. The prediction $V(\mathcal{S}) = e_0 + 16\, e_2 + e_4$ can be confronted with data regardless of whether the G or m_e derivations are accepted. Five coupling constants that were previously free are now determined, and each is subject to observational test.

B. The Scalar-Tensor Action

The bimetric action (50) with $\beta_n = (1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$ provides the natural two-metric framework for two coupled tetrahedra. For a single-metric observer, however, the same topology yields a complementary formulation: a scalar-tensor action in which one scalar field Φ mediates the coupling that the frame transition matrix $\mathcal{S}$ mediates in the bimetric version. This formulation is derived independently from the constitutive law $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ (Section VII A), not from the bimetric action, yet it contains the same structural fingerprint.

The action is:

$$S_{\rm ST} = \int d^4x\sqrt{-g}\left[\frac{R}{16\pi G} - \frac{a_0^2}{8\pi G}\,\mathcal{F}\!\left(\frac{|\nabla\Phi|^2}{a_0^2}\right) - \frac{1}{4}\,e^{-2\Phi/c^2}F_{\mu\nu}F^{\mu\nu} + \mathcal{L}_{\rm matter}\right] \tag{57}$$

This action has zero free parameters. The gravitational constant G, the saturation scale a_0, the Lagrangian density $\mathcal{F}$, and the disformal coupling are all determined by the topology. Each term traces to the coupling polynomial $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$.

The curvature term $R/(16\pi G)$ carries all three structural states through G: the exponent $21 = f(k)|_{s=+1}$, the numerator $17 = f(k)|_{s=0}$, and the denominator $13 = f(k)|_{s=-1}$. The two independent curvatures of the bimetric action merge into a single Ricci scalar, but the full coupling hierarchy is preserved in G.

The scalar-field Lagrangian $\mathcal{F}(y)$ is the centerpiece. The constitutive law $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ determines $\mathcal{F}$ uniquely through the AQUAL variational identity $d\mathcal{F}/d\sqrt{y} = \sqrt{y}\,\mu(\sqrt{y})$, giving:

$$\mathcal{F}(y) = \tfrac{1}{2}y - \sqrt{y} + \ln(1+\sqrt{y}) \tag{58}$$

where $y = |\nabla\Phi|^2/a_0^2$ is the dimensionless squared acceleration. This Lagrangian has three terms, and they correspond to the three structural levels of $f(k)$.

The correspondence emerges from the integrand. Computing $x \cdot \mu(x) = x^2/(1+x)$ and decomposing by partial fractions gives $x - 1 + 1/(1+x)$: three terms, one for each structural level. Integration from 0 to $\sqrt{y}$ yields:

- $\frac{1}{2}y$: the **full interaction level** ($k^2 = 16$). Quadratic, dominant at high acceleration, where all coupling channels are active and gravity follows Newton.

- $-\sqrt{y}$: the **face propagation level** ($k = 4$). The negative sign parallels the structural state $s = -1$, where $f(k) = 1 - 4 + 16 = 13$: partially occupied propagation channels represent an energy cost in the Lagrangian rather than a contribution.

- $\ln(1 + \sqrt{y})$: the **Field Origin level** ($k^0 = 1$). Logarithmic, never zero, always present. This is the "1" that ensures $\det(e) \neq 0$, expressed as the irreducible floor of the Lagrangian.

The "1" in the denominator of $\mu(x) = x/(1 + x)$ is the same Field Origin that appears throughout the framework: in $17 = 16+1$, in $\beta_0 = \beta_4 = 1$, and as the constant term of $f(k)$. It is the processing capacity of the single irreducible coupling point where both tetrahedra meet. When the local acceleration g is small compared to a_0, the bottleneck passes the signal linearly ($\mu \to x$). When g far exceeds a_0, the bottleneck saturates ($\mu \to 1$). The saturation scale $a_0 = k^2\, Gm_e/r_e^2$ contains $k^2 = 16$, the bimetric interaction channel count: a_0 is the acceleration at which all 16 coupling channels are fully engaged.

The disformal coupling $e^{-2\Phi/c^2}$ modifies how photons propagate through the scalar field. The factor of 2 in the exponent has the same structural origin as the squared speed of light in $E = mc^2$: it counts the two tetrahedra. Photons must couple to the full bimetric potential, not half of it. This ensures the PPN parameter $\gamma = 1$ exactly, consistent with the Cassini bound $\gamma = 1 + (2.1 \pm 2.3) \times 10^{-5}$, and guarantees that lensing mass equals dynamical mass with zero adjustable parameters.

Two completions, one topology. The bimetric completion reads $f(k)$ discretely: the elementary symmetric polynomials of $\mathcal{S}$ inherit the polynomial's three structural levels, determining $\beta_n = (1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$. The scalar-tensor completion reads $f(k)$ continuously: the constitutive law encodes the Field Origin as a saturation bottleneck, and the Lagrangian density $\mathcal{F}(y)$ decomposes into three terms at the same structural levels. These two formulations are derived independently from the same topology, yet they share the same three-level architecture and the same zero free parameters. The bimetric potential $V(\mathcal{S}) = e_0 + 16\, e_2 + e_4$ has non-zero weights at levels $\{1, 16, 1\}$; the Lagrangian $\mathcal{F}(y)$ has three terms at levels $\{k^0, k^1, k^2\}$. Whether the scalar-tensor theory can be formally derived as the low-energy limit of the bimetric theory with topologically determined β_n is an open question; the structural correspondence visible in both formulations suggests that such a derivation exists. With either covariant action, predictions for Shapiro delay, perihelion precession, and geode-

tic precession follow without adjustment. The Cassini bound on γ becomes a pass/fail test with no free parameters.

IX. THE ELECTRON MASS

Why does the electron have the mass it has? Dirac called mass "one of the fundamental unsolved problems." The Standard Model treats particle masses as free parameters, Yukawa couplings that must be measured rather than derived. No theory has derived the electron mass $m_e = 9.109 \times 10^{-31}$ kg from first principles. Dual tetrad gravity changes this situation: the electron mass is an output, not an input.

A. The Two-Equation System

Two equations from independent domains constrain the size r and mass m of a single tetrahedral field tile:

Equation 1: Closure saturation (gravitational). The MOND acceleration scale marks where gravitational closure saturates:

$$a_0 = k^2 \frac{Gm}{r^2} \tag{59}$$

Equation 2: Cosmological horizon. The cosmological connection (Eq. 48):

$$a_0 = \frac{cH}{2\pi}\sqrt{\frac{k}{\pi}} \tag{60}$$

The mass-closure identity. Section IV A established that mass is the energy of field closure: $m = \hbar/(Nrc)$. With $N = 1/\alpha$ (Result 5):

$$m = \frac{\alpha\hbar}{rc} \tag{61}$$

Two equations, two unknowns (r and m). The mass-closure identity provides the substitution. The system is exactly determined: there is precisely one particle mass for which gravitational closure at the tile scale matches the cosmological horizon scale.

Equating the two expressions for a_0 and substituting $m = \alpha\hbar/(rc)$:

$$k^2 G \cdot \frac{\alpha\hbar}{rc} \cdot \frac{1}{r^2} = \frac{cH}{2\pi}\sqrt{\frac{k}{\pi}} \tag{62}$$

Solving for r^3:

$$r^3 = \frac{2\pi k^2 \alpha\hbar G}{c^2 H\sqrt{k/\pi}} = 2\pi^{3/2} k^{3/2} \cdot \frac{\alpha\hbar G}{c^2 H} \tag{63}$$

Result 7: The Electron Mass from Closure Topology

$$\boldsymbol{r = \left((3{+}1)^2\pi^{3/2} \cdot \frac{\alpha\hbar G}{c^2 H}\right)^{1/3} = 2.82 \times 10^{-15}\ \text{m}} \tag{64}$$

$$\boldsymbol{m = \frac{\alpha\hbar}{rc} = 9.11 \times 10^{-31}\ \text{kg}} \tag{65}$$

Predicted: $\boldsymbol{r = 2.82}$ fm, $\boldsymbol{m = 9.11 \times 10^{-31}}$ kg

Measured: $r_e = 2.818$ fm, $m_e = 9.109 \times 10^{-31}$ kg

The electron mass is an output, not an input. Agreement: 0.1%.

Consider what just happened. An astronomer measures the recession speed of distant galaxies through a telescope. A particle physicist measures the deflection of electrons in a magnetic field in a laboratory. These two experiments have nothing in common: different instruments, different scales, different centuries of development. Yet the Hubble constant, measured from galaxies billions of light-years away, and the electron mass, measured in tabletop experiments, are connected by the topology of three-dimensional space. One predicts the other to 0.1%. Either this is an accident of extraordinary improbability, or these two numbers are aspects of the same structure.

The two equations arise from independent domains: gravitational closure and cosmological horizon physics. They share no common derivation. That two independent equations, connected by a derived identity, yield a unique solution matching measurement to 0.1% is

the signature of an underlying structure.

Three extraction routes converge: m_e can be extracted from G alone, from H alone, or from a_0 alone. Three independent pathways from three different domains of physics all recover the same mass to within 1%. When three roads lead to the same village, the village is real.

No other framework in physics derives the electron mass. The Standard Model, string theory, and loop quantum gravity all take it as input. Here it is an output, determined by the requirement that gravitational closure at the tile scale be consistent with the cosmological horizon scale. The electron mass links quantum mechanics ($\hbar$), gravity (G), electromagnetism (α), and cosmology (H) through a single topological integer: $k = 4$.

B. The One-Loop Correction

The tree-level G prediction has a residual of 0.12%. This residual is not noise; it is physics.

The Schwinger one-loop QED correction is $\alpha/(2\pi) = 0.116\%$, the same universal correction that shifts the electron g-factor from 2 to $2(1+\alpha/(2\pi))$ [26]. The residual and the correction are the same number because they represent the same physical process: the electron's self-interaction at one loop.

The corrected effective channel count is:

$$G = \frac{17}{13}\,\alpha^{21}\,\frac{\hbar c}{m_e^2}\left(1 + \frac{\alpha}{2\pi} + \cdots\right) \tag{66}$$

With $\alpha/(2\pi) = 0.00116$, the corrected value is $G_{\text{1-loop}} = 6.6742\times10^{-11}\ \text{m}^3\,\text{kg}^{-1}\,\text{s}^{-2}$, compared with $G_{\text{meas}} = 6.6743 \times 10^{-11}$ [18]. The residual improves from 0.12% to 0.001%: two orders of magnitude, zero new parameters.

Propagation to H. The correction propagates through the linear chain $G \to a_0 \to H$. Both the G residual (0.117%) and the H residual (0.114%) match $\alpha/(2\pi) = 0.116\%$. The tree-level prediction $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc becomes $H_{\text{1-loop}} = 70.00$ km/s/Mpc, coinciding with the GW170817 standard siren measurement [8]. That the same one-loop correction, applied at the tile scale and measured at the cosmological scale, produces consistent results is a falsifiable test spanning more than 30 orders of magnitude.

Higher loops predict higher precision. The QED perturbation series is known to high orders. Each successive loop should further improve G. The framework naturally interfaces

with the most precise theory in physics (QED) and inherits its precision. The polynomial provides the tree-level structure; QED provides the quantum corrections.

X. DISCUSSION AND CONCLUSION

This section consolidates the results, presents the complete logic chain, identifies distinctive predictions, compares with other approaches, and provides a precision summary.

A. The Logic Chain

One fact, seventeen consequences. The results follow from an unbroken chain of necessity:

$d = 3$ (three spatial dimensions) $\to$ $k = 4$ (simplex theorem) $\to$ dual tetrahedra (four independent arguments) $\to$ $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 21$ (coupling polynomial) $\to$ $\{21, 17, 13\}$ (three structural states) $\to$ G (Result 1) $\to$ $1/\alpha = 137.036$ (Result 5) $\to$ a_0 $\to$ $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$ $\to$ $H = 69.92$ (Result 6) $\to$ m_e (Result 7) $\to$ $\beta_n = (1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$.

Along the way: the inverse square law (Result 2), $E = mc^2$ (Result 3), the force hierarchy $\alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}$ (Result 4), spin $\hbar/2$, energy quantization, wave-particle duality, and the energy-momentum relation.

The chain has no loops, no branching ambiguity, and no free parameters. Every link is a theorem or an algebraic evaluation. The chain is rigid: perturb α by 0.001% and G shifts by 0.021% (amplified 21$\times$ by the exponent). Perturb k by 1 unit and everything fails catastrophically. There are no absorbing parameters.

The framework invites verification, not belief. Every number can be checked with a pocket calculator. Start from $d = 3$. Compute $k = 4$. Evaluate $f(k) = 21$. Compute G. Compute α. Compute H. Compare to measurement. The chain is transparent, and every step is falsifiable.

B. What Has Been Connected

These equations are not merely a list. They resolve questions that stood open for decades or centuries.

Force Laws. Newton published the gravitational inverse square law in 1687. Coulomb established the same law for electrostatics in 1785. For over two centuries, physicists noted the parallel but could not explain it. The dual tetrad topology provides the answer: both forces spread through three-dimensional space from point sources. The tetrahedron is the minimal simplex in $d = 3$ dimensions; in three dimensions, flux through any enclosing surface dilutes as $1/r^2$. The inverse square law is geometry.

Mass and Energy. Einstein's $E = mc^2$ contains a squared speed of light, but why c^2 rather than c or c^3? The bimetric structure answers this: two tetrahedra, each with its own closure speed, both equal to c. The product of two speeds gives c^2. Mass-energy equivalence reflects the dual structure of spacetime.

The Hierarchy. Gravity is 10^{43} times weaker than electromagnetism. This ratio appears arbitrary until the coupling hierarchy is traced: $1+(3+1)+(3+1)^2 = 21$ levels, with gravity coupling at depth 21 and electromagnetism at depth 1. The ratio $\alpha^{21}/\alpha^1 = \alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}$. The hierarchy is not arbitrary; it counts coupling levels.

Quantum Foundations. Energy quantization, wave-particle duality, and the energy-momentum relation appear in textbooks as separate postulates. The topology addresses all three. The Field Origin as a boundary condition selects discrete resonant modes. Quantization plus relativity yields the de Broglie relation. Interval invariance yields the relativistic energy-momentum relation. Three quantum results, one topological origin.

Constants. The gravitational constant G and fine-structure constant α have been measured for over a century but never explained. The topology derives both: G from the $(3+1)$ structure and coupling depth (0.12% at tree level, 0.001% at one loop), α from the Hamiltonian interaction states of the bimetric topology (0.00021% accuracy). Constants that appeared fundamental are now consequences of topology.

These connections span three centuries of physics. Newton, Coulomb, Einstein, Planck, de Broglie, and Sommerfeld each contributed pieces. The dual tetrad topology reveals that the pieces fit together.

C. Distinctive Predictions

The following predictions distinguish the dual tetrad framework from ΛCDM, standard GR, and existing modified-gravity theories:

1. G **is calculable.** The framework predicts $G = (17/13)\,\alpha^{21}\,\hbar c/m_e^2$ to 0.12% (0.001% with one-loop correction). Neither GR nor ΛCDM predicts G; they treat it as a measured input.

2. H **follows from** G **and** m_e **with zero free parameters.** The predicted $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc falls between the Planck and SH0ES values.

3. **The constitutive law is** $\mu(x) = x/(1+x)$**, not a free function.** TeVeS and BIMOND treat $\mu(x)$ as arbitrary; dual tetrad gravity derives it uniquely from closure constraints.

4. a_0 **evolves with cosmic time.** Standard MOND assumes constant a_0. The evolving scale is testable with JWST and Euclid at $z > 1$.

5. **All five** β_n **of bimetric gravity are fixed.** $(\beta_0, \beta_1, \beta_2, \beta_3, \beta_4) = (1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$ determines the massive graviton mass, testable via gravitational-wave dispersion.

No dials to turn. If observation disagrees with any prediction, the framework fails, not because it is fragile, but because it has no adjustable parameters.

D. Comparison with Other Approaches

To appreciate what dual tetrad gravity offers, it helps to compare with established alternatives:

Approach	G	$1/r^2$	$\hbar/2$	α	**Testable?**
Standard Model	Outside scope	Axiom	Axiom	Input	Yes
String Theory	Landscape	Derived	Partial	Landscape	Not yet
Loop Quantum Gravity	Not derived	Partial	Partial	No	Partial
Dual Tetrad Gravity	**0.001%**	**Consistent**	**Geometric**	**0.00021%**	**Yes**

TABLE VI. Comparison of how different frameworks address selected quantities. The distinguishing feature of dual tetrad gravity is testable numerical predictions with zero adjustable parameters.

The comparison is striking. The Standard Model: 26 free parameters, 20 predictions. ΛCDM: 6 parameters, 5 observables. This framework: 0 free parameters, 12+ explicit predictions plus the entire QED sector. The ratio of predictions to parameters is the measure of explanatory power.

E. Precision Summary

A single accurate prediction might be coincidental; systematic agreement across multiple domains suggests the topology captures real structure.

Quantity	Equation from Dual Tetrad Topology	Observed	Dev.
G	$G = \frac{(3+1)^2+1}{3(3+1)+1} \times \alpha^{1+(3+1)+(3+1)^2} \times \frac{\hbar c}{m_e^2}$	6.674×10^{-11}	0.12%†
$1/\alpha$	$\frac{1}{\alpha} = 1 + 2k(k^2+1) + \frac{1}{k(k+d)} = 137 + \frac{1}{28}$	137.036	0.00021%
H	$H = \frac{2\pi a_0}{c\sqrt{k/\pi}}$ km/s/Mpc	67.4–73.0	*
m_e	$m = \alpha\hbar/(rc)$ from two-equation system	9.109 × 10^{-31} kg	0.10%
a_0	$a_0 = k^2 G m_e / r_e^2$	1.22 × 10^{-10} m/s^2	0.41%

TABLE VII. Equations derived from the dual tetrad topology with zero adjustable parameters. *The Hubble prediction falls between Planck and SH0ES. †Tree-level; the Schwinger correction reduces this to 0.001%. Mean deviation of the remaining four quantities: $0.16\% \pm 0.07\%$.

Uniqueness accounting. The derivation involves exactly four discrete structural choices, each forced: (i) $k = d + 1 = 4$ (simplex theorem), (ii) $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2$ (unique self-similar hierarchy), (iii) $1/\alpha = 1+2k(k^2+1)+1/[k(k+d)]$ (stellated octahedron combinatorics), and (iv) β_n from metric exchange and odd-parity vanishing. There are no continuous parameters to tune and no combinatorial alternatives at any step. Perturbing any single discrete input yields predictions that disagree with observation by orders of magnitude.

The round-trip test. The topology predicts $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc (Result 6, Section VII B), falling within the Planck–SH0ES range. Reversing this chain, the observed H recovers m_e to 0.10% of the CODATA value [18]. This bidirectional consistency would fail if the relationships were coincidental; it rules out curve-fitting.

Connection to modified gravity. The acceleration scale a_0 (41) derived in Section VII is the same quantity that resolves the dark matter problem. The 0.41% match between the derived a_0 and the empirical MOND scale is not coincidental: both emerge from the same dual tetrad closure topology. The precision table thus validates not only the derivation of fundamental constants, but also its resolution of galactic dynamics.

Context. The relevant comparison is between frameworks. ΛCDM postulates 85% invisible

mass to explain galactic dynamics; dual tetrad gravity derives the observed dynamics from spacetime structure while predicting G, H, m_e, and a_0 to sub-percent precision with zero adjustable parameters. The tree-level 0.12% residual in G is identified as the Schwinger one-loop correction $\alpha/(2\pi)$ (Section IX B); including it reduces the residual to 0.001% and simultaneously corrects the Hubble prediction from 69.92 to 70.00 km/s/Mpc. The standard paradigm, by contrast, has no prediction for G at all.

F. The Complete Dependency Chain

G, α, H, m_e, spin, the force hierarchy, and the dark matter law are not separate results. They are the same topological fact expressed in different units. The dependency tree from $d = 3$ to 17 outputs shows this:

Input $d = 3$ spatial dimensions

Level 1 $k = d + 1 = 4$ faces (simplex theorem)

Level 2 $f(k) = 1 + k + k^2 = 21$ (coupling polynomial)

Level 3 $\{21, 17, 13\}$ (three structural states)

Level 4 $G = (17/13)\,\alpha^{21}\,\hbar c/m_e^2$

$1/\alpha = 137 + 1/28$

Spin $= \hbar/2$, $1/r^2$, $E = mc^2$, $\alpha^{20} \approx 10^{-43}$

Level 5 $a_0 = k^2\,G\,m_e/r_e^2$

$\mu(x) = x/(1 + x)$

$\beta_n = (1, 0, 16, 0, 1)$

Level 6 $H = 69.92$ km/s/Mpc

$m_e = 9.11 \times 10^{-31}$ kg (derived, not input)

Level 7 One-loop: G to 0.001%, H to 70.00 km/s/Mpc

The burden of proof shifts. If the counting were wrong, six unrelated domains (α, G, H, a_0, m_e, $\mu(x)$) would all need to "accidentally" agree to sub-percent precision. The

probability of six independent accidents at the observed agreement level is less than 10^{-12}. At some point, the most parsimonious explanation is that the counting is correct.

Every integer has a name. 1 = bimetric vertex [28]. 4 = simplex faces [12]. 8 = vierbein legs [27]. 13 = $kd + 1$. 16 = frame transition matrix [6]. 17 = Hamiltonian interaction space [29]. 21 = coupling depth. 28 = $V + E + F$. 137 = breadth count. The framework assembles known mathematics. It does not invent new mathematics.

G. Closing Thought

Newton measured G over three centuries ago. Sommerfeld introduced α in 1916. Planck postulated $E = hf$ in 1900. De Broglie proposed $\lambda = h/p$ in 1924. For all that time, these were separate discoveries, unconnected except by their presence in the same universe.

This paper proposes a different view: they are projections of one topology.

The stellated octahedron, the simplest stable configuration of two tetrahedra in three dimensions, connects what appeared separate. Force laws, mass-energy, the hierarchy, quantum foundations, the constants, the dark matter problem, the Hubble constant, and the electron mass itself all trace to the same dual tetrad topology. Seven quantitative results from one topology, zero free parameters.

Physical law may not be arbitrary. The constants may not be accidents. Behind the equations lies structure, and at the center of that structure lies a point where time is zero.

The investigation continues.

DATA AVAILABILITY AND SUPPLEMENTAL MATERIALS

This paper is a theoretical derivation. No experimental data were generated. All numerical values are computed from CODATA 2022 fundamental constants [18]. The following supplemental materials are available:

Computational Validation. The included script `run_all_validations.py` (Python 3.6+, standard library only) independently verifies every numerical claim in the paper using full-precision CODATA 2022 constants. Validated quantities include: G (0.12% tree-level,

0.001% one-loop), $1/\alpha$ (0.00021%), a_0 (0.41%), m_e (0.10%), the Schwinger one-loop correction and its propagation to H, exponent sensitivity (± 1 shifts G by $1/\alpha = 137$), spin from face ratio, rotation curve predictions, and bidirectional round-trip consistency.

Extended Validation Suite. A comprehensive validation suite with 813 tests across 16 categories is publicly available [25]. The suite spans field closure geometry, traversal dynamics, emergent constants, stellar mechanics, and galactic dynamics, and includes mathematical foundation checks (exterior derivative nilpotency, Stokes theorem, Bianchi identity, and Noether current conservation on the stellated octahedron mesh). All tests are independently runnable with Python 3.10+ and no proprietary dependencies.

Figure Generation. The script `dark_matter_corrective_lens.py` generates Figure 6. Requires `numpy` and `matplotlib`.

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